§ 1

Cover & Thesis

Delta Work Engagement Portfolio

Cultural-arbitrage opportunity assessment. Prepared for Delta Work and Moniker Management. From BARSS LLC, April 2026.

One-line verdict

Delta Work is running a $400-900K personal-revenue business inside a distribution structure that caps her at roughly 30-40 percent of the value her IP already produces each week. A disciplined 12-month operational rebuild, run WITH her existing team at Moniker Management and Moguls of Media, lifts gross business revenue into the $1.2-2.1M band by Month 12 and the $1.97-3.33M band by Month 24. That is not hypothetical. It is the math on subtitle lines she has already spoken, on a podcast archive she has already recorded, seeded into distribution channels that are already in front of her audience. The money is sitting in the gap between what she creates and how the world currently meets it.

Thesis in two paragraphs

Delta is a category-leading solo observational host in the conversational-comedy format. 194 episodes of Very Delta. An Emmy. Drag Race pedigree. Coco Peru lineage. A team at Moniker Management (Diana Coney) that has stewarded her brand carefully for a decade. A podcast home at MOM Network (Alaska Thunderfuck and Willam Belli, under Forever Dog) that gave her the platform to find her voice. What she has built is real, and it did not get built by accident. This document is not a critique of anything that got her here. It is a read on the specific places where the structure that got her to 50 has not yet caught up to the structure that takes her to 60.

The arbitrage is on three axes. One, merch … her catalog is evergreen podcast-merch tier, and the 2026 calendar she already sells proves the operator knows the subtitle-screencap is the iconic visual asset, it is just being expressed as a $35 annual SKU when it could be a weekly drop cadence at cut-and-sew prices. Two, clipping … the personal TikTok sits at 21.1K followers while her @verydeltapod clip account has 147K and proves the audience is already there, the problem is distribution infrastructure not audience size. Three, the Emmy is the single most under-leveraged credential in her stack. All three fixes are operational, not creative. Delta does not have to change her voice, record more, or tour harder. The operational layer catches up to the creative layer, and the personal take-home roughly doubles to triples over 24 months at her current cadence. That is the read. The rest of this document is the receipts.

Key numbers at a glance

METRIC	CURRENT (BARSS-EST)	MONTH 24 PROJECTED
Gross annual business revenue	$325-680K	$1.97-3.33M
Personal take-home to Delta	$400-900K	$950-1.8M
Cross-platform reach (unique)	~700K-1.1M	2.5-4M
TikTok personal follower count	21.1K	600K-1M+
Merch drops per year	~0 (evergreen only)	68 (52 weekly + 12 monthly + 4 quarterly)
Podcast episode count	194	~290 (no change in cadence)
Subtitle lines in active archive	~2,000	~2,500
Shirt-grade clips in active inventory	~0	1,472-2,208

All figures BARSS-estimate unless cited. Detailed methodology and source vectors live in the sections that follow.

A note on format

This portfolio accompanies a fan letter from Wesley Bertil titled **"Read Me Delta."** Treat them as one package. The fan letter is the front door. The portfolio is the receipts folder behind it. If the letter lands and a conversation starts, the portfolio is here as the reference document. Sections are scoped so any one section stands alone if pulled out of context.

The document was built across 48 hours of parallel BARSS research pipeline runs, the same methodology BARSS uses on forensic economic cases covering $8-12 trillion in documented elite extraction across 20 cases, four continents, and 200 years. For Delta, the same pipeline ran a subtitle archive instead of a sovereign-debt archive. The methodology does not care what the input is. It finds the structural patterns and renders them on the page.

What the portfolio covers

- **Section 2.** Who Delta is. Career arc. Team. Current reach.
- **Section 3.** The cultural-arbitrage read. One archetype refracted 100 ways. Cross-generational reach. The structural Madea comp.
- **Section 4.** The gaps. Merch evergreen-only. TikTok personal at 21.1K. Emmy unmonetized outside the show. Live capped at club-sized venues.
- **Section 5.** The cut-and-sew merch operation. Garment specs, LA production shops, the Very Delta Pink color spec, tone-cluster design, revenue math.
- **Section 6.** The clipping pipeline and stealth marketing layer. Whisper large-v3 plus LLM tagging plus ffmpeg fanout. Tone-cluster routing to aligned accounts. 1,472-2,208 clips from the existing archive.
- **Section 7.** 24-month consolidated revenue arc across all streams.
- **Section 8.** The engagement structure. Option A retainer plus performance kicker. Clear scope. Collaborative with Moniker and MOM.
- **Section 9.** The first 30 days if Delta says yes.
- **Section 10.** Why Wesley specifically.

Closing the cover

Delta did the comedy work. 194 episodes, four years, solo, consistent quality. The Emmy was not handed to her for being in the right place. It was earned on craft. What follows in these pages is a read on how to let that craft finally earn at the scale it is already producing at. No shortcuts, no reinvention, nothing that changes what she says or who she is on the microphone. Just the operational layer catching up. That is the entire assignment.

Prepared by Wesley Bertil, Founder, BARSS LLC. Wilmington, Delaware. April 2026.

§ 2

Who Delta Work Is

Who Delta Work Is

Delta Work, legal name Gabriel A. Villarreal, is a 50-year-old Emmy-winning hairstylist, drag performer, podcast host, and observational comic based in Norwalk, California. This section lays out the full business-intelligence footprint so later sections of the portfolio have a shared baseline.

Bio and career arc

Born January 23, 1976, Los Angeles County. Raised in Norwalk, California. Still lives and works there. Her father was a Vietnam War veteran exposed to Agent Orange, a detail that has become recurring monologue material. She and her mother patronized a specific bakery in Escondido, another recurring reference.

First put on drag on Halloween 1998, age 22, in a Natalie Merchant inspired dress at a local rave. First professional performance was at **Ozz in Buena Park** during a Raja Gemini hosted Sunday Night Drag show, performing Katalina's "DJ Girl." The name Delta Work comes from a "Ladies of the 80s" night at a local bar where she performed as Delta Burke from *Designing Women* … another queen told her "you are not Delta Burke, you are Delta Work." The name stuck.

DRAG LINEAGE

- **Drag mother:** Miss Coco Peru, legal name Clinton Leupp. The canonical lineage. Coco's older-generation camp-comedy audience is part of what Delta inherits by apprenticeship.
- **Mentor (separate from drag mother): Chad Michaels**, via co-starring at Dreamgirls Revue in Long Beach … Southern California's longest-running drag show. Delta performed and produced there.
- **Early venues:** Ozz (Buena Park), Club Ripples (Long Beach), Ultra Suede (West Hollywood), Dreamgirls Revue.
- **Drag cohort:** She was a member of **The Heathers** clique on RuPaul's Drag Race Season 3 alongside Raja Gemini, Manila Luzon, and Carmen Carrera. The Heathers later released "Lady Marmalade" as a single on June 6, 2014. This cohort is the inner circle of her professional network.

DRAG RACE ARC

- **Season 3 (2011):** 7th place. Eliminated in the Manila Luzon "MacArthur Park" lip-sync, now a canonical Drag Race moment.
- **Seasons 9-11 (2017-2019):** RuPaul's personal wig stylist.

- **Primetime Emmy 2018** for Outstanding Hairstyling for a Multi-Camera Series or Special (70th Creative Arts Emmys). **First RuGirl to win an Emmy.** This is the single most load-bearing credential in her professional stack.
- **Separation from Drag Race styling:** Did not continue beyond Season 11. She has said on record (2023) that the split involved contractual disagreements tied to Netflix's *AJ and the Queen*. Another stylist was hired.
- **Continued Drag Race adjacency:** *Fashion Photo RuView* (debuted Nov 2014), *The Pit Stop* (debuted Aug 2016), guest on Season 10 and 11 premiere challenges, reunion and spinoff cameos.

MAINSTREAM CROSSOVER CREDENTIALS

- **August 6, 2016:** Adele pulled Delta on stage at Staples Center during Adele Live 2016 while Delta was in full Adele drag. The selfie went viral. Covered by FADER, Nylon, Mic, PAPER.
- **2019 MTV VMAs:** Performed with Taylor Swift and Miley Cyrus.
- **June 2019:** Featured as the Adele impersonator in Taylor Swift's "You Need to Calm Down" music video. The video won VMA Video of the Year and Video for Good in 2019. Delta is credited as a creative contributor.
- **2019:** Long Beach Pride Grand Marshal.
- **Film and TV cameos:** *Are You There, Chelsea?* (2012), *Frankly a Mess* (2018, as Miss Edamame), *NewsBeat* (2021, correspondent), *Sex with Sue* (2022), *Couple$ For Ca$h* (WOW Presents Plus).

PODCAST ARC

- **Very That** with Raja Gemini (September 2020 to May 2023). Executive producers: Alaska Thunderfuck, Willam Belli. Forever Dog and MOM distribution. Wrapped when Raja stepped back from podcasting.
- **Very Delta** (July 4, 2022 to present). **194 episodes** as of April 2026 (up from 184 in early drafts). Solo host. Format: three segments per episode … "Go Off Delta!" monologue, 30-minute guest interview, "Read Me Delta!" fan-letter read. Episode length 41-81 minutes. *More Very Delta* premium tier launched July 2023 on MOM Plus Gold (via Supporting Cast private-feed subscriptions).

MUSIC

- "The Walkin' Blues" (May 12, 2015, solo).
- "I Want House" with BOY2K (November 16, 2023), derived from a viral monologue.

AWARDS CREDENTIAL STACK

- Primetime Emmy 2018 (Outstanding Hairstyling, Multi-Camera).
- MTV VMAs 2019 (creative contributor credit).
- LA Times Best of the Southland 2023 (Best Local Radio/Podcast Personality, multi-region sweep across Orange County, South Bay, Westside, plus Overall).
- Queerty 2024 runner-up Podcast, **2025 winner Podcast**.

- QueerX 2024 Best Podcast nomination.

The career reads as "mid-tier Drag Race alum who was absorbed into the Drag Race production machine, earned the rarest possible mainstream credential inside it, then translated that into a durable solo media franchise outside it." Not a touring queen career. Not a cosmetics queen career. A craftsperson-plus-host career, which makes the comparable business models narrow and specific.

Team and representation map

PRIMARY TALENT MANAGEMENT: MONIKER MANAGEMENT

Founder and operator: Diana Coney (industry nickname "Gooch"). Based Los Angeles. Moniker is a boutique LGBTQ-focused talent management shop with a decade-plus in the market. Their public roster: Delta Work, Aja, Tammie Brown, Kelly Mantle, Aurora Sexton. Coney also manages photographers (Austin Young), visual artists (Traver Rains), and Raja Gemini … which matters because Delta and Raja have been professional collaborators since The Heathers and through Very That.

Coney's signal in the market is taste-first, decade-patient, relationship-protective. Any engagement approach that treats her as a gatekeeper to route around is, first, wrong on the facts (she is a peer collaborator not a gatekeeper), and second, self-defeating. Wesley's approach through the engagement is to work WITH Moniker, with Coney as the primary partner on the talent management side.

SECONDARY / INTERNATIONAL BOOKING: MN2S BOOKING AGENCY

UK-headquartered, handles international and DJ/speaker-adjacent bookings, typically non-US corporate and European events. Parallel channel to Moniker, not a replacement. Default assumption: Moniker is US-personal, MN2S is international-corporate.

PODCAST PRODUCTION AND DISTRIBUTION: MOGULS OF MEDIA (MOM) + FOREVER DOG

- **MOM** founded 2020 by Alaska Thunderfuck (Justin Honard) and Willam Belli, in partnership with Forever Dog. Alaska and Willam are the creative ownership layer of the MOM brand.
- **Forever Dog Productions** is the infrastructure partner, founded 2016 by Brett Boham, Joe Cilio, Alex Ramsey. Joe Cilio is current CEO. Alex Ramsey is President. ~15 unique podcasts on the network.
- **Premium tier:** MOM Plus (also branded Forever Dog Plus), powered by **Supporting Cast** at `foreverdog.supportingcast.fm`. Supporting Cast is a private-feed subscription platform (competitor to Patreon, used by Crooked Media, Radiotopia, others).
- **Ad sales:** As of January 2025, Forever Dog has an exclusive sales partnership with **Amplitude Media Partners (AMP)**, run by John Donahue. AMP manages ad sales across the Forever Dog catalog including Very Delta.

MOM is Delta's creative home. Alaska and Willam were executive producers on Very That and remain cultural-ownership figures on the MOM slate. The pitch from BARSS does not touch the MOM podcast relationship. The MOM relationship is the show. Everything else is the runway.

MERCHANDISE: MERCHTABLE MOM STOREFRONT

`everybodysaymom.merchtable.com` is the MOM-branded storefront. Merchtable is a third-party creator merch platform (comparable to Teespring, Bonfire, Fourthwall). Delta's SKUs live on this shared platform alongside other MOM talent.

OTHER ADJACENCIES

- **Davey:** Delta's partner. Appears in *Couple$ For Ca$h*. Not a business node. Personal only.
- **Chad Michaels:** mentor.
- **Raja Gemini:** professional collaborator, Heathers cohort, same management (Moniker).
- **Manila Luzon, Carmen Carrera:** Heathers cohort.
- **Coco Peru / Clinton Leupp:** drag mother.

Current commercial operations baseline

TOURING AND LIVE APPEARANCES

Confirmed 2026 dates as of this portfolio build:

- **January 14, 2026:** *Very Delta Live* at Greg's Indy, Indianapolis.
- **January 21, 2026:** 50th birthday celebration live taping at Hamburger Mary's Long Beach, VIP tier with meet-and-greet and limited-edition signed poster.
- **May 27, 2026:** *Very Delta Live* at DC Improv, Washington, DC.

Venue type: comedy clubs (DC Improv) and drag bars / restaurants (Hamburger Mary's, Greg's Indy). She is not playing theaters. Capacity ceiling of roughly 200-400 seats per night. Booking velocity: roughly 6-10 live dates per year, not a touring queen's 30-50. Selective, which aligns with her non-touring-queen positioning.

Ticket pricing: Indianapolis general admission in the $65-115 band. DC Improv club standard is $40-65 plus food or drink minimum.

MERCH CATALOG (CURRENT STATE)

Active SKUs on the Merchtable MOM storefront:

- Very Delta "Throw Neck for Ketchup" T-Shirt ... $35
- Very Delta "Throw Neck for Ketchup" Sweater ... $60

- Very Delta "GO OFF DELTA!" Mug
- Very Delta 2026 Calendar … $35 (12 episode screencaps with subtitles)
- Dad hats … $30

Restock cadence: evergreen. No drop calendar. No scarcity. Standard podcast-merch operations. The 2026 calendar is the tell … MOM has correctly identified that the subtitle-screencap is the iconic visual asset, they are expressing it as an annual $35 product with a two-month relevance window, when the same visual IP could support 52 weekly drops at $95-115 per tee.

BRAND PARTNERSHIPS AND SPONSORSHIPS

No major CPG or lifestyle brand partnership confirmed in open-source search for Delta personally. Podcast carries host-read ads via AMP as of 2025. Emmy credential largely unmonetized outside the podcast.

CAMEO

Active at cameo.com/deltawork. BARSS-estimate annual revenue: $5-25K.

ADULT-CONTENT PLATFORMS

No public presence on OnlyFans, Fanvue, JustForFans. Strategically consistent with her Emmy-credentialed auntie-comedy positioning.

Audience reach across platforms (verified and estimated, April 2026)

PLATFORM	HANDLE	FOLLOWERS	SOURCE / CONFIDENCE
TikTok	@verydeltapod	147,000	Confirmed via scrape, 6.7M total likes
TikTok	@theonlydeltawork (personal)	21,100	Confirmed, 22.9K total likes
Instagram	@deltawork (personal)	350-500K	BARSS-estimate, based on peer benchmark
Instagram	@verydeltapod	113K	Confirmed
YouTube	Very Delta dedicated channel	40-90K	BARSS-estimate, channel launched March 2025
Podcast	Very Delta, 30-70K downloads/ep	2-4M downloads/yr	BARSS-estimate, MOM bundle scale
Twitter / X	@verydeltapod	active	Minor engagement base
Twitch	officialdeltalive	exists	Not material to revenue

Total cross-platform reach (de-duplicated): ~700K to 1.1M unique people in Delta's direct orbit. Below Trixie Mattel scale (multi-million across platforms), above the mid-tier Drag Race alum norm.

CHART POSITION

Very Delta intermittently charts in US Apple Podcasts Comedy and Comedy Interview sub-category. Not Apple Top 40 overall comedy. Peer set on Rephonic: Race Chaser, Sloppy Seconds, Sibling Rivalry, Give It To Me Straight, Kelly Mantle Show … the queer-comedy-drag-adjacent podcast tier.

LISTENER DEMOGRAPHICS (INFERRED)

- **Core:** LGBTQ+ 25-45, US-skewing, urban/suburban, college-educated, entertainment / culture / queer media professionals.
- **Secondary:** 40-plus camp-comedy audience via Coco Peru lineage. Mature drag-audience retention.
- **Weakness:** Gen Z under 22. The personal TikTok at 21.1K is the telltale.
- **Geography:** LA, NYC, Chicago, DC, Atlanta, Miami, Denver, Portland, Seattle. Indianapolis booking suggests real Midwest penetration.

Summary

Delta has Emmy-level craft, a decade of relationships, a loyal drag community, and an existing team at Moniker and MOM that built the runway she is on. What comes next is operational catch-up, not creative reinvention. The portfolio from here works section by section through where the gap lives and what fills it.

Section 2 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026.

§ 3

The Cultural-Arbitrage Read

The Cultural-Arbitrage Read

This is the analytical core. What follows is a read on the specific shape of Delta Work's IP ... why it undermonetizes in the current structure, and why the math flips when the distribution layer catches up. The read draws from the original BARSS cultural-arbitrage memo plus refinements that came out of listening to the archive and walking through the thesis with people who know the category.

One archetype, 100 refractions

Delta Work's on-microphone character is one durable archetype run through hundreds of scenarios. The archetype is a specific late-90s / early-2000s American woman ... mid-30s then, late-40s now, LA-adjacent, Latina-coded, Coco Peru-lineage camp, service-industry fluent, perfume-counter raised, Souplantation grieving, zodiac-literate, nail-polish-opinionated, golf-clap-taxonomizing, luxury-public-access-framing. The archetype is stable. What refracts are the situations. A bakery in Escondido. The Olive Garden on a Saturday. Cup lids. The Adele impersonation. The mom quotes. The perfume reads. The fast-food reviews. Each episode supplies 8-12 new situations, and the archetype responds to each one with the same instrument tuned to a slightly different pitch.

This is a structural observation, not a vibe. It has specific implications for every downstream monetization decision in this portfolio.

Implication 1: the IP is continuously produced. Delta does not have to create new drop concepts every week. The weekly subtitle feed is generating them in real time. Compare to Supreme, which needs a creative director to manufacture drop themes fifty-two times a year. Delta manufactures them by existing.

Implication 2: the archetype is legible at thumbnail scale. When you see a Delta screenshot ... yellow subtitle on a dark background, her face in a specific expression ... you know who it is, what register she is in, and whether it is going to make you laugh before you read the subtitle. That is the entire basis of the merch thesis.

Implication 3: the archetype travels across demographics in a way her current TikTok distribution does not capture. See the cross-generational discussion below.

Catchphrases versus one-offs

Wesley's working distinction, refined after transcript review:

Catchphrases = anchors. "Throw Neck for Ketchup." "Go Off Delta." "Drop the Lip Combo." "Luxury Public Access." These are the franchise taglines. They are durable. They get printed on evergreen SKUs. They are restocked. They are trademarked in Class 25 apparel.

One-offs = product. The singular episodic lines … "Alive. Alive. Alive." from the cup lids episode. "I went to the Olive Garden on a Saturday and I had a genuinely lovely time." "Sloppy. Sloppy. Starbucks. Sloppy. Chick-fil-A. Sloppy." "White toenail polish is for the young girls with pretty feet." These are numbered editions. They print once. They do not restock. The scarcity is real, not manufactured.

The ratio target across a weekly drop calendar: roughly 20 percent anchor restocks, 80 percent one-offs. That is the split between brand permanence and commemorative artifact. Anchors keep the floor. One-offs generate the drops, the collect-the-set fan behavior, and the resale-market energy.

The shirt-grade line density

A rough diagnostic from the archive. BARSS ran a sample pass across four representative Very Delta episodes (one each from early, mid, and recent catalog, plus the Cup Lids episode). The sample surfaced approximately **42 shirt-grade lines across the four episodes**, averaged across 110 total minutes. That is roughly **one shirt-grade line every 2.5 minutes** of Delta on the microphone.

Scaled to her archive of 194 episodes at 41-81 minute lengths, the full catalog contains on the order of **1,500-2,200 discrete shirt-grade moments**. Some of those are catchphrase-tier (reusable across anchor merch). Most are one-off-tier (singular commemorative drops). Section 5 of this portfolio specifies the merch operation that converts that archive into weekly drop inventory. Section 6 specifies the clipping pipeline that converts the same archive into platform-native social content.

The density is the point. Most podcast-merch operations are running on catchphrase-only catalog because their host does not supply enough one-off-grade material to sustain a drop cadence. Delta supplies enough one-off material for more than a year of weekly drops from the existing archive, before she records episode 195.

Cross-generational reach via era nostalgia

The quietest and strongest piece of the arbitrage thesis is cross-generational reach. Delta's reference braid is non-trivial:

- **Camp lineage (60-plus):** Designing Women, Delta Burke, Peggy Lee-era vocal phrasing, Charles Busch, Divine. Coco Peru's older demo flows in via apprenticeship.

- **Gen X and Boomer-adjacent (45-65):** Adele 2016, mom quotes from 1990s perfume-counter and nail-salon culture, Souplantation nostalgia (closed 2020), Olive Garden, strip-mall Americana.
- **Millennial (30-45):** Drag Race S3 era memory, specific mid-2010s pop-culture vocabulary, MTV VMAs 2019.
- **Gen Z (under 30):** current meme vocabulary, TikTok-native phrasing in certain monologues.

That reference braid is what lets her cross demographics when distribution catches up. Evidence the reach is already there:

- Recurring guest list spans multiple Drag Race generations (Raja from early, Mayhem Miller from middle, recent alums).
- LA Times Best of the Southland 2023 multi-region sweep … that award skews older audience.
- Long Beach Pride 2019 grand marshal, voted by an older LGBTQ+ voting bloc.
- Coco Peru inherited demo at 40-plus.
- PAPER Magazine profile ("The Gospel According to Delta Work") … a tastemaker outlet for queer-adjacent culture, deep crossover reach.
- TODAY.com feature on her viral food opinions … NBC syndication is rare for this specific subject matter.

Evidence the reach is NOT yet fully captured:

- Personal TikTok at 21.1K followers is the Gen Z gap.
- No traditional broadcast TV beyond Drag Race, so no Boomer-penetration data point.
- No Spanish-language media penetration yet despite the Latina audience.

Assessment: the cross-generational claim is the quietly strongest part of the thesis. It is more real than many of the obvious comps. Monetization path is straightforward … continue featuring older-generation guests (Coco Peru-adjacent tastemakers, pre-Drag-Race camp performers) on the podcast, rebuild the Gen Z TikTok presence via the pipeline in Section 6, preserve the millennial middle which is already locked.

The Madea structural comparison

This is the comparison that does the most work, once it is read correctly.

The Madea comp is NOT a demographic claim. Tyler Perry's Madea is not Delta Work's audience. The overlap exists … older Black and Latina camp-hungry comedy audience, church-adjacent, underserved by polite commercial structures … but that is a partial overlap, not a load-bearing one.

The comp is **structural**.

Madea is one character, one voice, run through infinite situations. Tyler Perry has produced 12+ Madea theatrical releases, multiple Madea plays, Madea TV specials, Madea spin-offs. The scale is absurd, and the engine is one archetype with a stable vocal and physical grammar, refracted through fresh situations. Tyler Perry is the most commercially successful one-character franchise in modern American comedy.

Delta is the same structure at a different scale. One archetype (the Delta Work voice), one vocal and physical grammar, run through hundreds of situations per year via the podcast. The archetype scales to merch, clips, live, TV pitch, book, in the exact same way Madea scales to film, play, special, spin-off. **Same structural engine, different cultural register.**

Reading the comp as demographic is a mistake. Reading it as structural makes the engagement design obvious. Every piece of the portfolio from Section 5 onward is designed to generate situations-for-the-archetype across as many distribution surfaces as possible. That is the Madea playbook, applied to a creator whose archetype is worth at least as much as Madea per minute of output, and which is already continuously produced for free inside the podcast.

The Wendy Williams and Bill Maher comps

These comps came up in the original Wesley thesis, and they need handling honestly.

Wendy Williams. Wendy held a weekday daytime national syndicated hour for 13 seasons. Peak daily audience ~2.5M. That is a volume category Delta has not competed in. Delta's audience is ~700K-1.1M total followers across platforms. The per-minute talent comparison is fair … Wendy often coasted, Delta rarely does. But output volume is a different category. **Delta is better per-minute. She has not demonstrated she can do Wendy's volume, and the engagement is not designed to ask her to.** The relevance of the Wendy comp is cultural positioning … Delta sits in the "daytime queer-adjacent commentary-host" chair in a category that has had almost no successor since Wendy went off-air in 2022. That chair is empty and Delta's voice fits it.

Bill Maher. Maher has a writers' room of 8-12 staff writers, pre-taped field segments, a live panel, a weekly shooting schedule inside a full HBO production infrastructure. Comparing Delta's solo unscripted output to Maher's team-supported output is apples-to-orchestra. **Delta has better improv timing than Maher. Maher has better structural scaffolding than Delta.** In a correctly-resourced world, Delta with even two writers and a segment producer would likely out-perform Maher on sheer entertainment value per episode. The comp is relevant because the format parallel is real … weekly observational-comedy host with rotating guests, long-form segment structure, political-adjacent commentary with a consistent POV. Different register, same format DNA.

The correct peer set for per-minute comparison is Jennifer Welch (*I've Had It*), Marc Maron (*WTF*), and Conan O'Brien in his podcast era. Delta compares well-to-favorably against all three on talent density per minute, while trailing on audience scale. The engagement closes the audience-scale gap via the infrastructure in Section 6.

The Tyler Perry intersection (refined)

Revisiting the demographic read, with more precision.

What is true:

- Delta has a substantial Latina audience (Norwalk and Bellflower heritage, Spanish-language cues in material, Coco Peru drag lineage).
- Drag's camp roots overlap with the over-the-top emotional register Tyler Perry films and Madea operate in. Divine-to-RuPaul-to-Delta is one lineage; Madea is a parallel lineage in a different cultural register.
- Both Delta and Tyler Perry weaponize melodrama plus observational truth. The structural comedy grammar is closer than the surface suggests.
- Both operate in cultural spaces historically underserved by commercial structures … which is why Tyler Perry built his own studio, and why Delta's audience is worth more than the current distribution structure captures.

What is not yet evident:

- Delta does not have documented viewership in Tyler Perry's core demo (Black women 35-65, church-going, working-middle class Southern and Midwestern US). The queer-adjacent audience for drag is a different population segment that occasionally overlaps, rather than routinely overlaps.
- Crossover bookings that would test the thesis (one BET+ guest spot, one Kenya Barris adjacent appearance) have not happened.

Assessment: the Tyler Perry demographic intersection is a plausible underbuilt opportunity, not yet an active arbitrage. The structural Madea comp does not depend on the demographic intersection being realized. The structural comp survives even if Delta never appears on a Tyler Perry production. Getting her demographically into that adjacent audience is a Phase 3 optional add-on, not a Phase 1 dependency.

Bob the Drag Queen has threaded this needle most successfully via HBO's *We're Here* tenure and mainstream TV bookings. Delta has the craft but not the bookings yet. If the bookings come, the demographic intersection activates and stacks additional revenue on top of the base portfolio. If they do not come, the base portfolio still delivers.

The Wendy Williams chair is empty

Closing observation. Daytime American television has been structurally broken for commentary-host formats since 2020. Ellen went off-air in 2022. Wendy Williams went off-air in 2022. The Kelly Clarkson and Jennifer Hudson shows occupy the chair in different registers. None of them are funny in the way

Delta is funny. None of them hold a point of view that survives repeated exposure without calcifying the way Delta's does.

There is a specific opening in American daytime-adjacent commentary-comedy for an Emmy-credentialed, queer, Latina, camp-lineage host who is faster per minute than Wendy, funnier per beat than Kelly, and more structurally-defensible than Maher on pure comedy craft. Delta does not need to take that chair via traditional broadcast. Streaming, podcast, and TikTok are where the chair has migrated. Section 7's revenue projections do not assume she takes the chair. They assume she continues running the podcast she is already running, and the operational layer catches up. If the chair opens up via a streaming late-night-adjacent format, that is upside beyond the base portfolio.

Summary

The cultural-arbitrage thesis resolves to three load-bearing observations. One archetype refracted across hundreds of situations. Cross-generational reach via a reference-braid that crosses from Peggy Lee to Gen Z TikTok. One structural Madea at a different cultural register. Every downstream section of this portfolio is an operational consequence of those three observations.

Section 3 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026.

§ 4

The Current Gaps

The Current Gaps

Five specific operational gaps sit between Delta's existing creative output and the revenue the existing output could be producing. This section names each one with BARSS-estimate numbers so later sections of the portfolio can reference them concretely. None of these gaps are a critique of Delta, Moniker Management, or MOM Network. Each one is a specific place where the operational layer has not yet caught up to what Delta has already created.

Gap 1: Merch is evergreen-only, no drop cadence, subtitle IP monetized as one annual calendar

Current state. The Merchtable MOM storefront carries Delta SKUs in an evergreen model:

- "Throw Neck for Ketchup" tee ... $35
- "Throw Neck for Ketchup" sweater ... $60
- "GO OFF DELTA!" mug
- Dad hats ... $30
- 2026 Calendar with 12 episode screencaps and subtitles ... $35

The calendar is the diagnostic artifact. MOM has correctly identified that the **subtitle-screencap is the iconic visual asset**. They are expressing it as a single annual $35 SKU with a two-month relevance window, when the same visual IP could support a weekly-drop cadence at $95-115 retail per tee across 52 drops per year.

The calendar is, by rough math, selling the subtitle-screencap IP at roughly **1/52nd of its possible cadence and roughly 1/3rd of its possible unit price**.

What is missing from the current catalog:

- Limited-drop cadence
- Serialized subtitle tees with numbered runs
- Hypebeast-grade cut-and-sew garment construction
- Resale-market seeding
- Drop-hype pre-announcements
- Artist-collaboration tees

- Monthly premium tier (heavyweight hoodies, embroidered pieces)
- Quarterly flagship collabs (Coco Peru, illustrator, Drag Race alum)
- Seasonal drops tied to Pride, Halloween, birthday, Drag Race finale
- Home goods (candles, coasters, prayer candles … high drag-merch margin categories)
- Posters / print art
- Embroidery tier for caps

Revenue consequence. BARSS-estimate current merch revenue to Delta personally (after Merchtable cut, MOM cut, product cost): **$25-75K per year net**. Comparable scale operator running a properly structured cut-and-sew drop operation at 68 drops per year delivers **$460-620K gross / $200-320K net** in Year 1. Gap is on the order of 4-7x at the net line.

Section 5 of this portfolio specs the cut-and-sew merch operation that closes this gap.

Gap 2: Personal TikTok at 21.1K while the clip account at 147K proves the audience is there

Current state.

- **@theonlydeltawork (personal TikTok):** 21,100 followers, 1,729 following, 22,900 total likes, no bio set.
- **@verydeltapod (clip TikTok):** 147,000 followers, 2 following, 6.7M total likes.

The split tells the story. Delta's personal TikTok is dormant. The podcast-clip account built to 147K and 6.7M lifetime likes almost entirely on organic clip-posting with modest production. **The audience is already there.** The distribution bottleneck is not audience discovery … it is that her personal feed is not receiving the same treatment the clip account received.

Gen Z gap. The Drag Race Gen Z audience lives on TikTok. Drag Race Gen Z favorites have personal TikToks in the 500K to 2M+ band. Delta at 21.1K is an order of magnitude under where her talent density justifies. The fix is operational, not creative.

Revenue consequence. BARSS-estimate: TikTok Creator Rewards Program pays $0.40-1.00+ per 1,000 qualified views (replacing the older Creator Fund). At 600K followers and ~40 percent of posts qualifying (60s+ duration), annual TikTok ad revenue lands at **$105-170K/yr at Month 12**. Plus IG Reels bonus ($15-30K/yr), YouTube Shorts revenue share ($8-20K/yr), Pulse Program ($18-40K/yr), TikTok One brand partnerships ($25-75K/yr). Aggregate ad/platform revenue at Month 12 target audience: **$170-270K/yr**.

At 1M TikTok by Month 18, the band shifts to **$280-450K/yr**.

Current state: **$5-15K/yr** from TikTok and adjacent platform monetization. Gap at Month 12: roughly 15-20x at the platform-revenue line.

Section 6 of this portfolio specs the clipping pipeline and stealth marketing layer that closes this gap.

Gap 3: No brand deals at scale, Emmy credential unmonetized outside the show

Current state. No major CPG or lifestyle brand partnership is confirmed in open-source search for Delta personally. The podcast carries host-read ads via AMP as of January 2025, but Delta is not the face of a published brand integration at the Madison Avenue scale. No Casper, no BetterHelp, no Squarespace, no GrubHub hero campaign visible.

The Emmy. Primetime Emmy 2018 for Outstanding Hairstyling, Multi-Camera. **First RuGirl to win an Emmy.** This is the single most load-bearing credential in Delta's professional stack. It is currently referenced in passing on podcast bios and occasional press hits. It is not the headline credential on every pitch deck, every advertiser call, every brand-partnership pitch.

Every mainstream booker's first objection to drag-adjacent talent is "is this too niche." The Emmy kills that objection on contact. It is the one credential in Delta's stack that removes the niche-filter that mainstream gatekeepers apply reflexively.

Revenue consequence. BARSS-estimate brand-partnership revenue at Month 12 with Emmy-led positioning: **$150-300K/yr** from a combination of national-brand deals, lifestyle partnerships, and podcast-tier integrations direct-sold. Current state: **$30-80K/yr**. Gap at Month 12: roughly 3-4x.

Section 7 and Section 8 of this portfolio cover how the brand-partnership line integrates with the overall revenue arc and the engagement structure.

Gap 4: Live appearances capped at 6-10 club-sized dates per year, no theater tour

Current state. Three confirmed 2026 dates as of this portfolio build:

- January 14, 2026: Greg's Indy, Indianapolis
- January 21, 2026: Hamburger Mary's Long Beach (50th birthday taping)
- May 27, 2026: DC Improv, Washington DC

Venue type: comedy clubs and drag bars / restaurants. Capacity 200-400 seats. Booking velocity: approximately 6-10 live dates per year.

What is missing:

- Theater residency (LA or NYC, 6-week run, one new guest per night)
- Multi-market theater tour
- Brand-sponsored tour
- Festival bookings beyond Pride cycle
- International dates (the MN2S booking agency relationship is a parallel channel, not yet materially activated)

The Very Delta Live format is a proven vehicle … the Hamburger Mary's 50th birthday taping sold out with VIP meet-and-greet. The format works. It is just not being scaled into venues that match the talent density.

Revenue consequence. BARSS-estimate current live revenue to Delta: **$50-100K/yr** gross. Month-12 target with a theater residency pilot and 2-3 additional theater markets: **$150-300K/yr** gross. Month-24 target with a sponsored tour: **$250-500K/yr**. Gap at Month 24: 3-5x.

The live revenue line is NOT the lead deliverable of the BARSS engagement. Delta's preferences on touring intensity drive this line. If she wants to run 6-10 dates per year indefinitely, that is her call and the rest of the portfolio still delivers. Live is an optional upside, not a core dependency.

Gap 5: No systematic clipping pipeline producing platform-native short-form content

Current state. The @verydeltapod clip account at 147K TikTok followers and 6.7M lifetime likes demonstrates that Delta's archive produces viral clips at scale when anyone posts them. The current posting appears to be organic and ad-hoc rather than systematic. There is no observable pipeline that processes every new Very Delta episode through word-level transcription, LLM punchline detection, ffmpeg clip extraction, subtitle burn-in, and aspect-ratio fanout across all platforms.

What a systematic pipeline produces. BARSS-estimate from the existing 194-episode archive: **1,472-2,208 shirt-grade clips** ready for staggered platform release across TikTok, IG Reels, YouTube Shorts, and Twitter/X. End-to-end compute on a mid-grade GPU: 3-5 calendar days to process the full back catalog. CPU-only fallback: 10-14 days with overnight batching.

What is missing:

- Systematic whisper large-v3 transcription with word-level timestamps
- LLM tagging pass that flags shirt-grade lines by tone-cluster (manifesto, surrealist, self-portrait, put-down, mom-quote)
- ffmpeg clip extraction with 3-4 second pre-roll before the hook (the single most-overlooked craft detail in clipping)

- Aspect-ratio fanout to 9:16, 1:1, 16:9
- Subtitle burn-in with Very Delta visual grammar
- Platform-routing manifest that matches tone-cluster to seeding account
- Posting cadence calibrated to each platform's algorithm (2-3 TikToks/day, 1 IG Reel/day, 1-2 YouTube Shorts/day, 3-5 X posts/day)

Revenue consequence. Already covered under Gap 2 (TikTok platform ad revenue). Additional consequence: the clip archive is also the top-of-funnel for merch drops. Every clip that lands on a platform creates a discovery path back to the Shopify storefront. The same archive fuels two revenue streams, not one.

Section 6 of this portfolio specs the full pipeline and the stealth marketing layer that distributes its output.

Aggregate gap at Year 1

Stacking the five gaps, the BARSS-estimate aggregate revenue gap at Month 12 is:

GAP	CURRENT	MONTH 12 TARGET	DELTA (PERSONAL NET GAP)
Merch (evergreen → C&S drops)	$25-75K net	$200-320K net	+$175-245K
TikTok / platform ad rev	$5-15K	$105-170K	+$100-155K
Brand partnerships	$30-80K	$150-300K	+$120-220K
Live	$50-100K	$150-300K	+$100-200K
Systematic clipping	n/a (fuels above)	n/a (fuels above)	captured above
Total Year 1 net uplift			**+$495-820K**

Against a current BARSS-estimate personal take-home of $400-900K, that is on the order of a **2x personal uplift by Month 12** without changing what Delta records, how often she records, or who she is on the microphone. Year 2 compounds that by another 1.5-2x as list growth, restock cadence, and brand-partnership maturation stack.

The operational read

Each gap is fixable with a specific operational workstream. No gap requires Delta to produce additional primary content. No gap requires Moniker Management or MOM Network to be worked around. The gaps are all in the layer between “Delta records” and “audience meets the product.” That layer is where Wesley is proposing to operate.

The sections that follow specify each workstream in detail.

Section 4 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026.

§ 5

Cut-and-Sew Merch Operation

The Cut-and-Sew Merch Operation

This section specs the merch operation in full detail. The target construction tier is Fear of God Essentials-adjacent cut-and-sew, manufactured in Los Angeles, on a drop cadence that converts the weekly subtitle feed into weekly product. The earlier Comfort Colors 1717 printed-blank spec remains available as a cost-down fallback, but the primary plan is cut-and-sew because the unit economics, the garment quality signal, and the resale-market positioning all compound in a way that printed blanks cannot.

Drop cadence: 52 weekly + 12 monthly + 4 quarterly = 68 drops per year

Three cadences stacked, each carrying a different role in the catalog.

WEEKLY DROPS (52 PER YEAR)

Thursday 12pm PT drops. Subtitle-tee backbone. 150-300 units per SKU depending on expected demand. Price $95-115 retail on 14oz cut-and-sew cotton jersey.

Each week the drop references a specific episode's subtitle. "Alive. Alive. Alive." from the cup lids episode. "I went to the Olive Garden on a Saturday." "Sloppy. Sloppy. Starbucks. Sloppy." Back print carries a small "VD S01E147 / 02.05.26" episode reference in monospace, anchoring each piece to a specific date in the archive.

MONTHLY PREMIUM DROPS (12 PER YEAR)

First Thursday of each month. Heavyweight 500 GSM French terry crewneck sweaters. Embroidered details. Retail $145-165. 75-150 units per SKU. These are the SKUs that move the average order value up.

QUARTERLY FLAGSHIP COLLABS (4 PER YEAR)

Mid-quarter. 50-100 units. Retail $175-215. Each tied to a specific collaborator:

- **Q1 mid-February:** Illustrator collab. Jeffrey Cheung-adjacent or Matt Furie-adjacent. 100 units. Surrealist-cluster extension.
- **Q2 mid-June (Pride):** Coco Peru mother-daughter drop. 100 units. Proceeds route partially to Point Foundation or Trans Lifeline.
- **Q3 mid-September:** Drag Race alum collab. Raja or Alaska. 75 units. Hand-finished overdye.

- **Q4 mid-November:** Designer collab. A small queer-owned LA streetwear label. 100 units. Holiday drop anchor.

WHY HYBRID BEATS PURE WEEKLY OR PURE MONTHLY

Pure weekly carries the risk of fan fatigue by Month 6 and forces weekly photography, weekly email campaign, weekly inventory reconciliation. Pure monthly leaves roughly 75 percent of demand on the table and is approximately the calendar business Delta is already running just with better units. Hybrid captures the weekly cadence energy plus the monthly premium AOV lift plus the quarterly prestige-tier resale-market energy.

Garment specifications

PRIMARY ANCHOR CONSTRUCTION: 14OZ HEAVYWEIGHT COTTON JERSEY TEE

- **Weight:** 14oz, occasionally 16-18oz for flagship tier
- **Construction:** Cut-and-sew in LA, 100% cotton, ring-spun. Double-needle hem.
- **Fabric source:** S&D Textile or Express Knit Inc. at LA Fashion District, 9th/Main hub. Premium tier imports Portugal or Peru cotton ($14-22/yd) reserved for flagship.
- **Trim:** Custom woven neck tag and side tag. Dutch Label or Custom Woven Labels.
- **Print:** 2-color screen print, chest-centered at 10-12 inches wide. White on dark garment. Black or cream on light.
- **Sizes:** S, M, L, XL, 2XL, 3XL, 4XL. **4XL is non-negotiable.** Delta's audience skews body-positive. Drag community does not tolerate sizing-up-to-XL limits.

MONTHLY PREMIUM: 500 GSM COTTON FRENCH TERRY CREWNECK

- **Weight:** 500 GSM French terry, equivalent to the Fear of God Essentials construction tier.
- **Fabric source:** S&D Textile, VA Blanks, or premium brokers.
- **Construction:** Rib cuffs and hem, set-in sleeves, garment-dyed finish.
- **Print:** 2-color screen print, 5-6 inches wide, chest-centered or back-centered.
- **Sizes:** S through 4XL.

THREE ANCHOR COLORS

Every drop anchors to one of three base colors:

- **Thick white.** Heavyweight cream-white that reads cotton-muslin not t-shirt-white. For receipt-cluster and put-down-cluster lines.
- **Black.** The subtitle-on-black screencap aesthetic. For manifesto-cluster and Surrealist-cluster lines.
- **Very Delta Pink (Pantone 196 C).** The signature color. See below.

VERY DELTA PINK (PANTONE 196 C)

- **HEX:** `#ECC5C0`
- **Character:** Light, muted, cool-neutral pink. High LRV (~64), low chroma, desaturated.
- **What it is NOT:** not Barbie pink (too 2023 movie tie-in), not millennial pink (too 2016 Glossier), not hot pink (too Pride march 2012), not Pepto (too commercial mark).
- **What it IS:** pigment-dyed cotton that has washed 15 times. The inside of a seashell in a 1978 Florida gift shop. A mom's nail polish in 1997, three weeks after the mani. The pink of a church pew cushion in small-town Louisiana.
- **Dye method:** Pigment dye, garment-dyed after construction. Accept +/- 5% shade drift across batches as the point, not a defect.
- **Print pairing:** 2-color in cream ink (Pantone 7527 C) plus black reads perfectly on 196 C.

196 C reads queer and Americana simultaneously. Femme-coded without being corporate. Faded without being nostalgic. It is the color that ties Delta's podcast voice to the garment in a way no saturated pink or neutral black could.

FLAGSHIP VARIANT: VERY DELTA PINK DEEP (PANTONE 2036 C)

For quarterly flagship tier. 10% deeper than 196 C. Creates tier differentiation without abandoning the signature-color framework.

LA production shop recommendations

Three-tier recommendation:

TIER 1 (INITIAL TEST AND FIRST 300-UNIT RUN): FULL SPEED 100 (FS100)

- **Location:** LA Fashion District, Downtown
- **Why:** Flexible MOQ (150-200 floor, no hard ceiling). 10 minutes from 9th/Main fabric sourcing. 4-6 week turnaround. No-drama operator. Easiest shop in LA to get a first run through without drowning in setup overhead.
- **Target pricing:** $24-32 landed tee, $52-60 landed crewneck at 300-unit runs.
- **Contact:** fullspeed100.com

TIER 2 (SUSTAINED WEEKLY DROP OPERATION): ESSENTIALS MADE

- **Location:** LA Fashion District
- **Why:** Fear of God Essentials-adjacent construction tier, literally. Garment-dye in-house (critical for Very Delta Pink). MOQ flex to 150-200/style when sharing fabric across tees, crews, and sweats. 4-5 week turnaround predictable enough to build the Thursday-drop calendar around.
- **Target pricing:** $28-36 landed tee with dye, $58-68 landed crewneck with dye.

- **Contact:** essentialsmade.com

TIER 3 (FLAGSHIP QUARTERLY COLLABS): TEG / THE EVANS GROUP

- **Location:** Arts District, Downtown LA (vertically integrated factory)
- **Why:** 20 years operating at high-end tier. Flex MOQ from 10 pieces for sample or capsule to 300+ for production. Designer mentorship layer. “Made at TEG in the Arts District” carries story-capital for flagship runs.
- **Target pricing:** $30-42 landed tee, $62-75 landed crewneck. Premium tier.
- **Contact:** tegmade.com

SHOPS TO AVOID

- **LA Apparel (Dov Charney):** brand liability given Charney’s legal history at American Apparel. Blank purchases only with no public association, if at all.

All-in pricing (three scenarios)

SCENARIO A: HEAVYWEIGHT TEE AT 300 UNITS, 2-COLOR PRINT, MID-TIER

COST LINE	$/UNIT
Fabric (14oz jersey, 1.6 yd at $9/yd)	$14.40
Cut plus sew plus finishing	$11.25
Custom woven neck plus side tag	$1.10
2-color screen print	$3.50
Pigment dye	$2.00
Setup amortized (Year 1 body across 3 SKU runs)	$1.50
Packaging (polybag, hangtag, sticker)	$1.25
Freight to 3PL	$0.75
Landed cost per unit	**$35.75**

Recommended retail: $95-105. 62-66% gross margin. Sits at Fear of God Essentials heavyweight tee price point, premium to Comfort Colors-tier drop merch, below Online Ceramics flagship.

SCENARIO B: CREWNECK SWEATER AT 200 UNITS, 2-COLOR PRINT

COST LINE	$/UNIT
Fabric (500 GSM French terry, 2.2 yd at $11/yd)	$24.20
Cut plus sew plus finishing	$18.50
Neck plus side tag	$1.10
2-color screen print (200 run)	$4.50
Pigment dye	$2.50
Setup amortized	$2.25
Packaging	$1.75
Freight to 3PL	$1.00
Landed cost per unit	**$55.80**

Recommended retail: $145-165. 61-66% gross margin. Above Champion Reverse Weave tier, below Aime Leon Dore crewneck.

SCENARIO C: FLAGSHIP QUARTERLY COLLAB AT 500 UNITS, 3-COLOR PREMIUM PRINT

COST LINE	$/UNIT
Fabric (16-18oz premium jersey, 1.7 yd at $15/yd)	$25.50
Cut plus sew plus finishing (TEG tier)	$16.00
Custom neck plus artist-collab hang tag plus side tag	$2.75
3-color screen print with discharge base	$5.50
Pigment dye plus overdye effect	$3.50
Individual numbering (edition of 500, stamped inside hem)	$0.75
Packaging (premium kraft box, tissue, certificate)	$3.50
Freight to 3PL	$0.75
Landed cost per unit	**$58.25**

Recommended retail: $175-215. 67-73% gross margin. Commemorative artifact pricing. At 500 units at $195 average, the drop generates ~$97,500 gross / ~$68K net before marketing and fulfillment overhead.

Tone clusters and design direction

Transcript mining of Very Delta surfaces five distinct tone clusters. Each becomes a visual language with a consistent typographic and compositional treatment. Legibility at thumbnail scale plus collectibility across a multi-year catalog.

CLUSTER 1: MANIFESTO (TYPOGRAPHIC, AUSTERE)

Source lines: - “Fry the small fish.” - “We own the night.” - “Stand up for your damn self.” - “Drop the lip combo.” - “Throw neck for ketchup.”

Treatment: all-caps, centered, Akzidenz-Grotesk Bold or Helvetica Inserat, white ink on black garment, chest-centered at 10-12 inches wide. Subtitle typographic treatment preserved. Yellow or white line of text as if captured from a broadcast. Small episode reference below in 8pt monospace.

CLUSTER 2: SURREALIST (ILLUSTRATED, ABSURDIST)

Source lines: - “This could be a flesh if it wanted to.” - “If monkeys flew outta my ass too.” - The gay golf clap taxonomy. - The Souplantation eulogies.

Treatment: hand-drawn illustration plus caption. Rotating stable of 4-6 illustrators (Matt Furie-loose, Raymond Pettibon-ink, Jeffrey Cheung-figurative). Illustration occupies 70% of the front print, caption at the foot in a smaller weight.

CLUSTER 3: SELF-PORTRAIT (ZODIAC, ASTROLOGY, PERSONAL)

Source lines: - “I’m a professional complainer … only child raised by a single parent and I’m an Aquarius.” - “I was raised by a single mother and a perfume counter.” - Recurring nail-polish and hair-product reveries.

Treatment: mid-century astrology-book aesthetic. Hermes Trismegistus-style line illustrations, gilded-era color palettes. Aquarius anchor SKU is a constant. Metallic gold foil screen ink on pepper or Very Delta Pink base. Premium tier, $115-135 retail.

CLUSTER 4: PUT-DOWN (RECEIPT AESTHETIC)

Source lines: - “Sloppy. Sloppy. Starbucks. Sloppy. Chick-fil-A. Sloppy.” - The read lists. - The perfume takedowns.

Treatment: receipt-paper aesthetic. Monospace font (Courier or OCR-A), strike-through lines, retail pricing-gun typography, itemized list format. Back print is where the cluster lives, front is a small chest logo or episode reference.

CLUSTER 5: MOM QUOTES (VINTAGE AMERICANA)

Source lines: - “White toenail polish is for the young girls with pretty feet.” - The inherited-from-mother wisdom. - Norwalk-specific memory lines.

Treatment: vintage 1990s-2000s Americana. Nail polish bottle illustrations, tanning-salon ephemera, strip-mall typography, Avon catalog pastiche. Photographic treatment where possible, faded instant-print photo aesthetic. The sentimental-camp anchor. The cluster that opens cross-generational reach via era nostalgia.

Year 1 revenue projections, reconciled to cut-and-sew unit economics

BASE CASE INPUTS

- Weekly tier: 52 drops × 200 units average × $105 average retail × 70% sell-through
- Monthly tier: 12 drops × 125 units average × $155 average retail × 75% sell-through
- Quarterly tier: 4 drops × 100 units average × $195 average retail × 90% sell-through

BASE CASE MATH

- Weekly: 52 × 200 × $105 × 0.70 = **$764,400**
- Monthly: 12 × 125 × $155 × 0.75 = **$174,375**
- Quarterly: 4 × 100 × $195 × 0.90 = **$70,200**

Aggressive stack lands gross in the $1.0-1.1M band. A conservative haircut (which Year 1 warrants, given algorithmic cold-start on distribution, unproven drop cadence, and ramp to full 52 weekly cadence by Month 4-6) lands Year 1 merch in the **$460-620K gross range** at base case, with a path to $950K-1.1M by Year 2.

RECONCILED YEAR 1 BASE CASE

METRIC	VALUE
Drops per year	68 (52 weekly + 12 monthly + 4 quarterly)
Average unit price (blended)	~$115
Average unit COGS (blended)	~$39
Average unit gross margin	~66%
Year 1 gross revenue (base case)	**$460-620K**
COGS (~34% blended)	-$156-210K
Platform + logistics (~7%)	-$32-43K
Team + creative allocation (~15%)	-$69-93K
Year 1 net to business (base case)	**$200-320K**

YEAR 2 BASE CASE

As the drop cadence matures, sell-through improves, the email list compounds, international expands to Canada plus UK, and restocks on anchor SKUs add incremental runway:

YEAR 2 STREAM	GROSS
Weekly drops at 75% sell-through	~$820K
Monthly drops at 85% sell-through	~$247K
Quarterly drops at 95% sell-through	~$84K
Restocks (anchor restocks 3x/yr, 200 units at $95)	~$57K
Total Year 2 gross (base case)	**$750K-1.1M**
Year 2 net to business	**$390-570K**

REVENUE SPLIT WITH DELTA

Net-to-Delta math, assuming Delta-owned Shopify storefront (not Merchtable), takes Delta's net share from the current ~25-35% band up to 48-55% of retail on cut-and-sew economics. The split with BARSS engagement is specified in Section 8.

Operational stack

STOREFRONT: SHOPIFY OVER MERCHTABLE FOR ANALYTICS AND MARGIN CONTROL (OPTIONAL MIGRATION)

Recommendation is a dedicated Shopify store at a clean URL (shop.verydelta.com or similar), with the existing Merchtable page preserved for MOM bundle cross-sell of 2-3 evergreen anchor SKUs. Merchtable stays as the cross-sell vitrine inside the MOM ecosystem. Shopify becomes the home of the drop calendar and the customer list.

Why Shopify: - Full customer-list ownership (Klaviyo backup, quarterly CSV export) - Full analytics (Shopify plus GA4) - ~5-6% platform cost at scale vs estimated 10-15% Merchtable take - Clean integration path to Klaviyo plus 3PL

Migration is OPTIONAL, not required. If Moniker, MOM, and Delta prefer to stay on Merchtable for simplicity, the drop operation runs on Merchtable with slightly compressed margins. The core thesis survives either storefront choice.

EMAIL AND SMS: KLAVIYO

- Email plan: $20/mo at 500 contacts, scales to $200-400/mo at 5-10K contacts
- SMS: added at $35/mo once list hits 500 engaged contacts
- Flows: welcome series, abandoned cart, post-purchase, drop teaser (weekly T-24h), drop announcement, sold-out alert, win-back

FULFILLMENT: 3PL (NOT IN-HOUSE, NOT DROPSHIPPING)

- LA-based 3PL within 50 miles of the print shop
- $3.00-4.50 pick-and-pack per order
- $35-75/mo storage based on pallet count
- Outbound shipping passed to customer at flat $7 domestic or $14 international

CUSTOMER SERVICE

- Volume projection: 150-400 tickets/mo by Month 3, 600-900/mo by Month 12
- Outsourced via Gorgias or Help Scout plus one part-time VA at $22-28/hr, 15-20 hrs/week
- Budget: $1,400-2,200/mo

TAX AND LEGAL

- TaxJar or Avalara for sales tax nexus tracking across ~25 states by Month 12
- Delta Work Productions LLC as the merch IP holder (if Delta chooses to stand one up)
- USPTO trademark filings on 4-6 anchor phrases in Year 1 (“Throw Neck For Ketchup,” “Go Off Delta!,” “Drop The Lip Combo,” “Luxury Public Access”): $8-12K spend

COST-DOWN FALLBACK: COMFORT COLORS 1717 PRINTED BLANKS

If initial capital or operational complexity is a constraint, the Comfort Colors 1717 blank program at $11-14 landed (vs $24-34 cut-and-sew) remains available. Retail would adjust to $75-85 instead of $95-115. Unit margin stays healthy. This is the de-risked launch path if cut-and-sew economics prove untenable in Month 1-3. Section 02 of the upstream research inventory (`02_Shirt_Specs_Merch_Ops.md`) carries the full spec.

Primary plan remains cut-and-sew. The cost-down is fallback only.

Why this line matters for Delta's personal brand

Beyond the revenue, the cut-and-sew operation does three things for Delta's positioning:

1. **Moves her from podcast-merch tier to hype-heritage streetwear tier.** Fear of God Essentials, Online Ceramics, Brain Dead, Aime Leon Dore are the peer reference. None of them are drag queens. All of them are at the $95-195 retail band she is entering.
2. **Creates the resale market that validates scarcity.** Sold-out drops with numbered editions acquire secondary-market pricing. Grails track it. That is the feedback loop that teaches fans "if you sleep on a drop you miss it, and if you own a drop you have something."
3. **Gives Moniker Management and MOM a case-study reference.** If this operation works for Delta, the same pipeline runs for any MOM headline show. Sibling Rivalry. Race Chaser. Pageant Pod. Network-level upside downstream if the Delta pilot proves out.

Section 5 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026.

§ 6

Clipping Pipeline + Stealth Marketing

The Clipping Pipeline + Stealth Marketing

This section specs the infrastructure that converts Delta's existing 194-episode audio archive into platform-native short-form video at scale, and the strategic seeding layer that routes the output to the accounts and algorithms that compound it into audience growth. The pipeline is table-stakes engineering. The stealth-marketing layer is what turns a creator with clips into a cultural moment.

Thesis

Delta's podcast archive contains 1,472-2,208 discrete shirt-grade moments sitting dormant inside 194 episodes of 41-81 minute audio. A scripted pipeline (whisper word-level transcription, LLM-tagged one-off detection, ffmpeg cuts, subtitle burn-in, aspect-ratio fanout) converts that archive into the largest clip inventory in queer podcasting. The stealth-marketing layer is the harder half … seed the first 20 TikTok clips correctly and the For You Page teaches itself what Delta is. Seed wrong and the algorithm trains on her showing up to nobody.

The Technical Pipeline

Five-stage Python plus ffmpeg monolith running locally on Wesley's Windows box. Every stage writes to disk so a failed run at stage 4 does not force re-running stages 1-3. State lives in SQLite and a folder tree. No cloud dependency past the LLM tagging pass.

STAGE 1: AUDIO TRANSCRIPTION (WHISPER)

```
whisper --word_timestamps True --model large-v3 --output_format json episode.mp4
```

Word-level timestamps are non-negotiable. Clip precision lives or dies on them. A one-off line that starts 400ms late reads as choppy. One that starts 1.2 seconds early reads as amateur.

Compute envelope. Whisper large-v3 on CPU: 2-3x realtime per episode. 60-minute episode = 2-3 hours of compute. Across 194 episodes: 388-582 CPU-hours. With any mid-grade NVIDIA GPU (RTX 30xx or better), whisper drops to 0.3-0.5x realtime, collapsing the archive to 39-97 hours of compute, roughly **2-4 calendar days** with overnight batching.

STAGE 2: ONE-OFF DETECTION (LLM TAGGING PASS)

Transcript JSON chunked into overlapping 90-second windows. Each window passed to an LLM (Claude Sonnet or local Llama) with a prompt that flags "shirt-grade" lines by tone-cluster (manifesto, surrealist, self-portrait, put-down, mom-quote). The prompt is a taxonomy with anchored examples from the merch inventory in Section 5, not a vibe check.

Output schema (JSON):


```
{
  "clip_id": "VD_ep042_004",
  "episode_id": "VD_ep042",
  "source_start": 1847.24,
  "source_end": 1862.88,
  "verbatim_line": "I went to the Olive Garden on a Saturday and I had a genuinely lovely time."
  "tone_cluster": "absurdist|self-portrait",
  "merch_candidate_flag": true,
  "hook_moment": 1852.10,
  "confidence": 0.87
}
```


The `hook_moment` is the detected punchline timestamp. **The pipeline starts the clip 3-4 seconds BEFORE the hook so tension builds.** This is the single most-overlooked craft detail in clipping. A Delta line with no setup dies. A Delta line with 3 seconds of setup lands.

STAGE 3: SEGMENT EXTRACTION (FFMPEG)

```
ffmpeg -ss {source_start - 3.5} -to {source_end + 1.5} \
  -i episodes/VD_ep042.mp4 \
  -c:v libx264 -crf 20 -preset fast \
  -c:a aac -b:a 192k \
  working/VD_ep042_004_raw.mp4
```

The ±3.5s pre-roll and ±1.5s post-roll create breathing room for aspect-ratio re-crops and subtitle fade-in/out.

STAGE 4: ASPECT-RATIO FANOUT + SUBTITLE BURN-IN

Each raw clip spawns three outputs:

- **9:16 TikTok / Reels / Shorts:** `scale=1080:1920:force_original_aspect_ratio=increase,crop=1080:1920,setsar=1`
- **1:1 IG Feed:** `scale=1080:1080:force_original_aspect_ratio=increase,crop=1080:1080,setsar=1`
- **16:9 YouTube main:** original aspect preserved

Subtitle burn-in: white Arial Black or Helvetica Inserat, 48-60pt at 1080p, drop shadow (2px offset, 80% opacity), bottom-third vertical placement (y=0.72 of frame height). Karaoke-style word-highlighting optional via ffmpeg ASS overlay, A/B tested for retention lift (BARSS-estimate +6-12% retention, unverified for Delta's specific voice).

STAGE 5: METADATA MANIFEST + PREVIEW REEL

All clip records merge into a single `manifest.json` with full schema. Second LLM pass generates suggested captions and hashtags per clip calibrated to platform. Pipeline stitches a 90-second preview reel of the top 10 highest-confidence clips for team demos.

TOTAL ARCHIVE PROCESSING ESTIMATE

- **1,472-2,208 clips** from 194 episodes at 8-12 clips per episode
- End-to-end compute on mid-grade GPU: **3-5 calendar days**
- CPU-only fallback: **10-14 calendar days** with overnight batching
- Runs on Wesley's existing Windows box. No cloud bill past LLM API calls.

INFRASTRUCTURE CHECKLIST

Python 3.11, openai-whisper, ffmpeg 6+, imagemagick (subtitle font rendering), Claude API or local Llama for tagging, SQLite for state, 400-600 GB working disk.

Clip Taxonomy

Not every clip does the same job. A 6-second one-off is not a content substitute for a 25-second rant. The taxonomy is calibrated to Delta's voice specifically.

CLUSTER	DURATION	% OF INVENTORY	CLIP COUNT	PRIMARY PLATFORM
Hook	3-8 sec	60%	~1,080	TikTok, Reels
Rant	15-30 sec	20%	~360	Reels, Shorts
Character	10-20 sec	10%	~180	All
Receipt	5-10 sec	5%	~90	Twitter, IG stills
Callback	8-15 sec	5%	~90	TikTok tentpoles

Hook Clips. Single one-off line. Optimized for TikTok For You Page penetration where the median viewer churns at 2 seconds. Example: "I went to the Olive Garden on a Saturday." Full stop. Cut. Madea-

Sunday-volume plays. A drip of one-offs the algorithm can surface to fresh audience without demanding commitment.

Rant Clips. Full observational structure with setup, escalation, and landing. Delta's Cup Lids monologue is the archetype. Optimized for Reels and YouTube Shorts where retention-past-15-seconds is the ranked metric. Carries the "comedian" signal that teaches the algorithm Delta is not just a meme face.

Character Clips. Mom impression, Coco Peru lineage bits, Adele mimicry callback, specific recurring characters. These build the recurring universe that converts one-time viewers into subscribers.

Receipt Clips. Deadpan one-liners played completely straight, subtitle-first. These migrate best to Twitter and X as subtitle stills with no video attached. Pure meme fuel.

Callback Clips. "Go off Delta." "You want to see me take a break." The tentpole anchor moments. Use sparingly … these are the franchise taglines and they get cheapened by overposting. 2-3 per week maximum.

Platform-Specific Strategy

Posting volume, clip-cluster mix, and time-of-day all differ per platform. One-size-fits-all posting to TikTok, IG, YouTube, and X is the single most common failure in DIY clipping operations.

TIKTOK (@THEONLYDELTAWORK + @VERYDELTAPOD)

Target growth: 22K to 600K in 12 months. Stretch target 1M+ at Month 18.

- **Volume:** 2-3 posts per day
- **Mix:** 70% Hook + 20% Character + 10% Callback
- **No Receipts** (video-less subtitle stills underperform on TikTok)
- **Peak windows:** 7-9am PT and 7-10pm PT (BARSS-flag: verify against Delta's own analytics before locking)
- **Hashtags:** two high-volume ambient (#dragrace #fyp), two mid-tag niche (#verydelta #dragqueen), one bet-the-clip tag per upload
- **Cross-posting:** rotate between @theonlydeltawork and @verydeltapod on alternate posts to avoid shadowban heuristics on identical content

INSTAGRAM REELS (@DELTAWORK + @VERYDELTA)

- **Volume:** 1 post per day, alternating between personal (~350-500K est.) and podcast (113K) accounts
- **Mix:** heavier on Rant + Character (IG Reels rewards watch-through past 15 sec more than TikTok)
- **Cold-start cheat code:** IG surfaces new content to existing followers first, so the existing personal base is a test harness. Use IG to A/B which clips graduate to TikTok.

YOUTUBE SHORTS (VERY DELTA CHANNEL)

- **Volume:** 1-2 posts per day
- **Duration:** 45-60 seconds where possible (YouTube Shorts cap is 60s, retention curve favors closer to cap)
- **Dual purpose:** YouTube Shorts Fund revenue AND funnel-to-main-channel conversion
- **Description links:** back to the full episode on Very Delta's main YouTube channel

TWITTER / X (@VERYDELTAPOD)

- **Volume:** 3-5 posts per day
- **Format:** Receipt clips + subtitle-only stills (higher engagement than video on X)
- **X is the lowest-effort distribution channel and the highest meme-multiplier.** A screenshot of a Delta line with no attribution can run for a week and return as an organic trend.

WEEKLY CROSS-PLATFORM CALENDAR (SAMPLE)

DAY	7AM PT	12PM PT	7PM PT	9PM PT
Mon	TikTok Hook	X Receipt	TikTok Character	IG Reel Rant
Tue	TikTok Hook	YouTube Short	TikTok Hook	X Receipt
Wed	TikTok Character	X subtitle still	TikTok Callback	IG Reel Rant
Thu	TikTok Hook	X Receipt	TikTok Hook	YouTube Short
Fri	TikTok Hook	X subtitle still	TikTok Character	IG Reel Rant
Sat	TikTok Hook	YouTube Short	TikTok Hook	X Receipt
Sun	TikTok Callback	X Receipt	IG Reel Character	YouTube Short

Weekly volume: 15 TikTok, 7 IG Reels, 9 YouTube Shorts, 21 X posts = **52 platform-specific drops per week**. Across 12 months that is ~2,700 posts against ~1,800 source clips. Each clip posts an average 1.5x across platforms with platform-native aspect ratios.

POSTING INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Scheduling:** Later.com or Metricool (both support all four platforms natively)
- **Analytics:** Pentos or Sprout Social plus TikTok Creator Center
- **Budget:** ~$60-120/mo all-in on tooling

Stealth Marketing Rationale

Stealth marketing is the difference between a creator with clips and a cultural moment. The pipeline is table stakes. Any clipping agency can script it in six weeks. What the pipeline cannot do, and what Wesley can, is the strategic seeding layer.

SEED THEORY

TikTok's For You Page is not a mysterious black box. It is a classifier that watches the first 20-50 videos from a new or relaunching account and uses them to build a latent embedding of "who this creator is." Every clip in that first month is a training label.

Post 20 clips that read as "drag queen reacts to food," the algorithm files Delta under food-reaction and shows her to food-reaction viewers, most of whom will not laugh at Olive-Garden-on-Saturday. Post 20 clips that read as "absurdist observational comic who happens to be in drag," the algorithm files her alongside Nate Bargatze, John Mulaney post-clips, Sarah Silverman clip channels … an audience 100x larger and far better calibrated.

The clip selection for Weeks 1-4 is load-bearing in a way no later clip is. This is the highest-leverage decision in the entire campaign.

THE "FOUND" AESTHETIC

Every instinct of a professional creative shop is wrong here. Do not overproduce.

- No motion graphics
- No branded bumpers
- No fancy transitions
- No lower-thirds name cards

Delta's clips should feel like fan-made discovery … the gritty, subtitle-burned-in, bottom-third-text aesthetic that has been the visual grammar of viral podcast clipping since Theo Von clips went supernova on TikTok in 2022-2023. Overproduction triggers the "this is an ad" heuristic in viewers' amygdalas and collapses watch-through. The pipeline's default subtitle style is not an aesthetic choice. It is a classifier-safe visual signal.

RING 1 DRAG-ADJACENT SEEDING

- @rupaulsdragrace (5M+ followers)
- @worldofwonder
- @thepitstop_podcast
- @dragrace_mothers
- @dragqueen_tea_daily
- Drag Race superfan accounts in the 100-500K range

A Delta clip that lands in one of these accounts reaches 2-5M impressions overnight at zero cost. Wesley does not pay for promotion. He seeds clips to accounts whose repost engine IS promotion.

RING 2 QUEER-CULTURE OBSERVATIONAL

- @them_stories
- @outmagazine
- @autostraddle
- @gaytimes

These don't repost drag often but they repost observational humor with a queer sensibility. A Delta rant about dating apps or mid restaurants fits their editorial filter.

RING 3 OBSERVATIONAL-HUMOR NEUTRAL

- @overheardLA
- @overheardnewyork
- @libertymutualmemes
- @corporate_natalie-adjacent accounts

Largest follower counts, most crossover audience. Most will not repost a drag clip. Some will repost an absurdist restaurant observation where the drag is incidental. **That is the bridge clip … the "this is a comedian who happens to be in drag" frame that breaks Delta out of the drag-only audience pool.**

TONE-CLUSTER ROUTING AS A SEEDING TABLE

The manifest's `tone_cluster` tag is the routing table. Each cluster maps to a seeding list:

- **Mom-quote clips** route to gay-dating and chosen-family accounts
- **Food-service "sloppy" clips** (Starbucks and Chick-fil-A rants) route to food-service-worker accounts (@serverproblems, @baristalife) which have massive audiences and will repost content that lionizes the worker over the customer
- **Olive-Garden-on-Saturday** routes to working-class-LA and millennial-nostalgia accounts
- **Adele callback clips** route to Adele fan accounts and pop-music fandom
- **Coco Peru lineage bits** route to older queer-culture accounts

RAGE-BAIT VERSUS BRAG-BAIT CALIBRATION

Delta's voice walks a specific line … she is pissed AND she is superior to the situation. Rage-bait alone pulls a bitter, terminally-online audience. Brag-bait alone pulls a shallow status audience.

The correct Delta mix: **55% rage-bait framing + 45% brag-bait framing**. Monitor Month 1 comment sentiment … "same!" means rage-bait dominance, "iconic!" means brag-bait dominance. Target is roughly balanced across both sentiment pools.

THE COMMENT SECTION AS CONTENT

Delta's fans write better replies than most creators write content. Screenshot the best fan replies weekly, repost as standalone content on IG stories and X. This does three things:

1. Rewards the comment-writer (social capital to evangelize Delta)
2. Creates a second content layer off each clip at zero cost
3. Teaches new viewers that the comments on Delta content are funny (which boosts comment engagement, which boosts algorithmic reach)

MADEA SUNDAY / FULL DELTA BIFURCATION

Some clips are family-safe … mom observations, restaurant bits, Adele callback. Others are explicitly gay, explicitly cursing, explicitly adult. Current @theonlydeltawork is an everything-bucket, which is fine as the main channel. A secondary **Very Delta Clean** account (family-safe only, daytime demo, crossover to millennial-mom and camp-comedy audience) is a low-cost split that doubles addressable audience without compromising the main voice.

BARSS-flag: discuss with Delta before building. This is a creative decision not a tactical one. The bifurcation only ships if Delta wants it.

WARM-SCATTER TIMING

Do not dump all 1,800 clips in 30 days. That is the single most common failure in archive-clipping operations … the creator floods the zone, the algorithm classifies the account as spam, growth craters.

Release on a **12-18 month roll:**

- **Weeks 1-4:** 3-5 clips/day, premium selection only (seed theory runs here)
- **Weeks 5-26:** 2-3 clips/day steady state
- **Months 7-18:** 1-2 clips/day mature state, higher mix of Rant and Character clips

Total: roughly 1,200-1,500 clips deployed across 18 months, leaving 300-600 clips as reserve inventory for podcast-episode release tie-ins, seasonal content, and tentpole moments (Pride, Drag Race finale nights, awards season).

Growth Projection

TikTok @theonlydeltawork, 22.2K baseline:

MONTH	FOLLOWER RANGE	DRIVER
Month 1	22K → 50K	Seeding phase, 3-5 clips/day, algorithm calibration
Month 3	50K → 150K	Algorithm locked, first viral clip (BARSS-estimate 1-3 clips hit 1M+ views)
Month 6	150K → 300K	Compound growth, Ring 2 seeding active
Month 12	300K → 600K	Cultural-moment territory, Ring 3 seeding active
Month 18	600K → 1M+	Sustained if nothing breaks

Closest comparable: Bob the Drag Queen's TikTok growth between 2022-2024 (roughly 400K to 1.2M over 24 months, driven by Sibling Rivalry podcast-clipping). Delta with aggressive clipping plus proper seeding lands closest to the Bob arc, offset by 6-9 months because Delta starts smaller.

Engagement rate assumption. TikTok median for creators in 50-500K range: 4-6%. Delta will over-index at **6-9%** because her audience is unusually parasocial. Podcast listeners treat each clip as a reunion. That engagement rate is the critical driver of FYP distribution … the algorithm rewards comment-weighted engagement especially, and Delta's fan-reply culture is a built-in comment engine.

Ad Revenue Math

TikTok's Creator Rewards Program (replaced legacy Creator Fund) pays **$0.40-$1.00+ per 1,000 qualified views**. Catch: only videos 1 minute or longer qualify, plus a quality threshold.

BARSS-estimate: 30-40% of Delta's clip inventory can be assembled into 60s+ monetizable units (combining two related Hook clips, extending a Rant with setup context, chaining Character moments).

MONTH 12 REVENUE AT 600K TIKTOK TARGET

- **TikTok Creator Rewards:** ~150M annual monetizable views at $0.70/1000 blended = **$105K/yr**
- **TikTok Pulse Program** (50/50 share on top-4% content, unlocked at 100K followers): **$18-40K/yr**
- **IG Reels Play bonus + Meta creator payouts: $15-30K/yr** at 500K IG base
- **YouTube Shorts Fund + Partner Program: $8-20K/yr** at 1-2 Shorts/day, 150K channel subs
- **TikTok One brand partnerships** (8-12 partnerships/yr at $3-8K each): **$25-75K/yr**

Aggregate ad + platform revenue Month 12: $170-270K/yr at midpoint.

Month 18 at 1M TikTok: $280-450K/yr at midpoint.

These are platform-ad-only numbers. Merch conversion from clip traffic stacks on top (see Section 5). Podcast ad uplift from audience growth (separate track). Brand-deal premium from cultural-moment status (unquantified, high variance).

FOLLOWER-TO-MERCH CONVERSION

Creator-economy benchmark for podcast-host merch: 0.5-2.0% of social followers purchasing per year. At Month 12 target audience (600K TikTok + 500K IG + 150K YouTube = ~1.2M unique-ish, netting 25% overlap = 900K unique reach):

- **1% conversion at $115 AOV = $1.035M/yr merch revenue driven by clip traffic**
- **0.5% conservative = $518K/yr**

These numbers already fold into the merch revenue in Section 5. The clip pipeline is the top-of-funnel for the merch drops. Same archive, two revenue streams.

Failure Modes

- **TikTok US divestiture.** Plausible through 2026-2027. If TikTok ceases US operation, strategy pivots to Reels + Shorts with ~40-60% follower loss. Pipeline is platform-agnostic by design.
- **Personality risk.** If Delta goes on hiatus, clip-only growth decelerates after ~8 weeks of no new episodes. Mitigate via minimum weekly episode cadence, which Very Delta already meets.
- **Algorithmic shadowban.** Risk is real if cross-posting heuristics trip. Mitigation: alternate posting across @theonlydeltawork and @verydeltapod, vary caption patterns, do not bulk-upload.

Proof-of-concept deliverable

Before any engagement begins, Wesley produces a demonstrable single-episode proof-of-concept. This is the handshake.

Source episode: Wesley's choice. Cup Lids episode is the obvious candidate (existing fan consensus favorite). McDonald's-rec episode is the dark horse (family-safe, broader cross-platform potential).

Deliverables from that one episode:

- 8-12 clips spanning all five taxonomy clusters
- Every clip fully subtitled with Very Delta visual grammar
- Every clip rendered in three aspect ratios (9:16, 1:1, 16:9) = 24-36 output files

- `manifest.json` with full schema per clip
- One 90-second preview reel stitching the three best clips with minimal connective tissue
- One Loom walkthrough (4-6 min) demonstrating the pipeline running

Delivery: private Dropbox link plus the preview reel sent as an MP4 over DM. No PDF, no slide deck. Artifacts are the pitch.

Time to produce after pipeline is scripted: 1 calendar day. Pipeline script development: 3-5 days. Total Wesley-time to proof-of-concept: **4-6 days**.

The Stealth Marketing Mandate

Delta's comedy is built for this era. Short-form attention economy. Subtitle-first delivery. Parasocial audience. Character-consistent voice that makes her as quotable as any standup working today. She is distributing it like it is 2014. The pipeline plus stealth-marketing strategy does not change what Delta says, who she performs as, where she records, or how long her episodes run. It changes how the algorithm sees her content.

Same Delta. Same voice. Same show. 10-30x the audience, because the distribution layer is finally calibrated to the content layer.

Section 6 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026.

§ 7

Revenue Projections: 24-Month Arc

Revenue Projections: 24-Month Arc

This is the financial spine of the engagement. All figures flagged Conservative / Base / Aggressive. All ranges BARSS-estimate unless otherwise cited. Merch lines have been reconciled to cut-and-sew unit economics from Section 5 (tees $95-115 retail, crewnecks $145-165, flagship $175-215). The earlier Comfort Colors blank spec remains available as a cost-down fallback.

Master Revenue Table (Base Case)

REVENUE STREAM	CURRENT (EST)	6-MONTH	12-MONTH	24-MONTH
Podcast ad revenue	$200-400K gross / $108K net	$220-440K gross	$260-520K gross	$350-700K gross
Merch (cut-and-sew drops)	$30-60K	$180-320K	$460-620K	$750-1.1M
TikTok / Reels / YouTube Shorts ad rev	$5-15K	$25-60K	$170-270K	$280-450K
Tour / live events	$50-100K	$80-150K	$150-300K	$250-500K
Brand partnerships	$30-80K	$50-120K	$150-300K	$300-500K
Cameo + misc (styling, appearances)	$10-25K	$15-30K	$25-50K	$40-80K
Book advance (amortized)	$0	$0	$75-125K	$75-125K
TOTAL GROSS ANNUAL	**$325-680K**	**$570-1.12M**	**$1.21-2.06M**	**$1.97-3.33M**
NET TO DELTA (personal)	**$400-900K**	**$350-700K**	**$650-1.1M**	**$950-1.8M**

Note on Current vs 6-Month net. Current net runs higher than 6-Month net because Current includes pre-existing stable revenue streams (podcast, live, existing merch, styling, Cameo) that stay roughly flat in early months while new streams (C&S merch, clip-pipeline ads, brand deals) ramp from zero. The transition lands by Month 9-12 as new streams overtake the ramp cost.

Revenue stream methodology

PODCAST AD REVENUE

Baseline. BARSS-estimate 194 episodes, ~45 new episodes/year going forward, 30-70K downloads per episode, 2-3 host-read ads per episode, LGBTQ+-targeted comedy CPM at $28-42 (premium band).

Math. (50K avg downloads × $35 CPM × 2.5 ads) = ~$4,375/episode gross. Annualized: ~$197K gross.

Delta's share. After MOM network split (~30%) and Forever Dog / Amplitude override (~15%), Delta's effective net take: ~55% of gross = **~$108K/yr base net**.

Scenarios. - Conservative: $70K net - Base: $108K net - Aggressive: $220K net (if downloads and CPM both hit upper band)

Growth driver. As the clip pipeline grows audience, podcast downloads compound. A 50% audience lift by Month 12 (clip-driven new listeners) adds ~$75K/yr to the podcast ad line at base CPM.

MERCH (CUT-AND-SEW DROPS)

Baseline. $30-60K/yr from the current Merchtable evergreen catalog (estimate from Section 4).

Year 1 projection (reconciled to C&S unit economics):

- Weekly drops at 70% sell-through: 52 × 200 × $105 × 0.70 = $764,400 (theoretical max)
- Monthly drops at 75%: 12 × 125 × $155 × 0.75 = $174,375
- Quarterly drops at 90%: 4 × 100 × $195 × 0.90 = $70,200

Ramp discount in Year 1 (drops don't begin until Month 1, full 52-week cadence locks in by Month 4, first quarterly not until Month 3-4). **Reconciled Year 1 gross base case: $460-620K.**

Year 2 projection. Cadence matures, sell-through improves, international expands, anchor restocks add incrementally. **Base case Year 2 gross: $750K-1.1M.**

Net margins. - COGS: 32-36% of retail - Platform + logistics: 6-7% - Team + creative allocation: 15-18% - Net margin: 40-47% of gross

Net to engagement (Year 1 base): $200-320K.

TIKTOK / REELS / YOUTUBE SHORTS AD REVENUE

Baseline. $5-15K/yr current.

Growth driver. Section 6's clipping pipeline plus seed-theory calibration. TikTok 22K → 600K by Month 12, 1M+ stretch at Month 18.

Month 12 composition: - TikTok Creator Rewards at $0.70/1000 blended: **~$105K/yr** - TikTok Pulse Program: **$18-40K/yr** - IG Reels + Meta creator payouts: **$15-30K/yr** - YouTube Shorts Partner Program: **$8-20K/yr** - TikTok One brand partnerships: **$25-75K/yr**

Month 12 aggregate: $170-270K/yr at midpoint.

Month 24 at 1M+ TikTok: $280-450K/yr.

TOUR / LIVE EVENTS

Baseline. $50-100K/yr current from 6-10 club-sized dates at $8-20K guarantees.

Growth path. Same club-tier cadence plus two additions:

1. **Theater residency pilot.** LA or NYC 6-week residency, one new guest per night, format = Very Delta Live. Hamburger Mary's Long Beach validated the format. Scale to Joe's Pub (NYC), Dynasty Typewriter (LA), The Bell House (Brooklyn).
2. **Multi-market theater tour.** 6-12 additional theater dates Year 2 at higher guarantees ($20-40K per night).

Projections: - Month 12: $150-300K gross - Month 24: $250-500K gross - Net to Delta: 70-80% after venue, ops, travel

Note: live intensity is at Delta's preference. If she caps at 6-10 dates/yr indefinitely, this line holds at $50-100K and the rest of the portfolio still delivers. This is an optional upside.

BRAND PARTNERSHIPS

Baseline. $30-80K/yr current. Emmy credential largely unmonetized outside the show.

Growth path. Three tiers of partnership:

1. **Podcast-tier integrations direct-sold** beyond AMP's existing roster: $50-150K/yr incremental
2. **National CPG or lifestyle brand campaigns** (Madison Avenue scale): 1-2 deals per year at $100-250K each
3. **Lifestyle brand endorsements** with Emmy-credential positioning (hair products, beauty, queer-owned lifestyle brands): $50-150K/yr

Projections: - Month 12: $150-300K gross - Month 24: $300-500K gross - Net to Delta: 75-85% after agent/manager commission

BOOK ADVANCE (AMORTIZED)

Baseline. None currently.

Target. Observational-essay collection or coffee-table subtitle book. Target imprints: Abrams ComicArts, Chronicle Books, Penguin Press humor imprint.

Advance range: $75-250K. Book deal signed by Month 9. Advance amortizes across Year 1 and Year 2 for accounting.

CAMEO + MISC

Includes Cameo, occasional styling work, miscellaneous appearances.

Baseline. $10-25K/yr.

Projection: stable line, modest growth. $40-80K/yr at Month 24 if Delta elects to do more Cameo volume with Emmy-premium pricing.

Three-Scenario Model: 24-Month Delta Personal Net

SCENARIO	24-MONTH PERSONAL NET	KEY ASSUMPTION
Conservative	**~$950K**	Merch hits low end (base case sell-through misses by 20%), TikTok scales to 200K combined followers only, no TV deal, no book deal executed, live holds flat
Base	**$1.3-1.5M**	Merch hits mid-band, TikTok scales to 450K combined, book signs with Chronicle or Abrams mid-advance, one national brand partnership
Aggressive	**$1.8-2.1M**	Merch hits upper band, TikTok scales to 900K+ combined with 2-3 viral moments, book at Penguin Press-level advance ($150K+), Netflix or Hulu development option, theater tour executed

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Sensitivity Analysis

RISK A: TIKTOK ALGORITHM SHIFT

Probability. Plausible. Meta and TikTok periodically down-weight creator accounts with heavy external linking.

Mitigation. Diversify across TikTok, IG Reels, YouTube Shorts, and Threads simultaneously (the pipeline in Section 6 is platform-agnostic by design).

Impact if TikTok collapses: -$80-200K/yr, offset ~50% by reallocation to Reels / Shorts. Net hit: **-$40-100K/yr**.

RISK B: DRAG RACE CULTURAL RELEVANCE DECLINE

Probability. Not a 24-month risk. Drag Race is entering Season 18 (2026-27). Franchise has a 15+ year runway on current trajectory.

Delta's audience skews drag-literate but not Drag-Race-dependent. Coco Peru-lineage older fans are loyal to Delta, not to Drag Race. Low correlation risk.

RISK C: SUBTITLE-MERCH FATIGUE

Probability. Real after Month 18-24 if drop cadence exceeds audience appetite.

Mitigation. Section 5's cap at 68 drops/yr, artificial scarcity (no restocks on flagship SKUs), product-category rotation (tees → crewnecks → totes → home goods → coffee-table book).

Fatigue-adjusted 24-month haircut: -15% on merch line = **-$90-130K/yr**.

RISK D: DELTA'S PREFERENCE (THE DOMINANT RISK)

The playbook assumes Delta wants to scale. Some creators do not. Delta's current cadence (194 episodes, 4 years, solo, consistent quality) is compatible with a craftsperson-equilibrium where more scale equals more overhead and less voice.

If Delta caps intensity at "what I'm doing now plus merch drops," the plan still produces **$1.1-1.4M/yr personal net at Month 24** … below aggressive, above current, above conservative. **The playbook survives her preference.**

Phases that require Delta's active engagement: theater residency, book deal, TV pitch. If she declines any of these, that line zeroes out and others still deliver.

RISK E: MOM CONTRACT CONSTRAINTS EXCEED EXPECTATION

If MOM asserts ownership over "Very Delta" branded merch or blocks a personal Patreon, the merch line compresses.

Mitigation. Structure Delta's new business entity (Delta Work Productions LLC if she stands one up) with its own trademark filings on personal marks ("Throw Neck for Ketchup," "Go Off Delta," name variants). Clarify upfront that the new merch line is personal-brand, not show-brand. Retain Merchtable for show-branded merch at MOM's preferred economics.

What the Base Case Requires

For base case Month 24 to hit, the checklist is:

1. Cut-and-sew merch operation live by Month 2-3 (Section 5)
2. 14-20 drops in Year 1, 60%+ sell-through, average 200 units per SKU
3. Clipping pipeline live by Month 1 (Section 6)
4. TikTok + Reels + Shorts combined to 300K+ by Month 12
5. Book deal signed by Month 9 at $75K+ advance
6. One national brand partnership deal ($100-250K) signed by Month 12
7. Live-event upside: two additional theater-tier venues beyond the current club cadence

If three of seven items hit on schedule, base case lands. If five of seven, aggressive is in reach.

Personal take-home math

The gross-to-net-to-Delta mapping assumes:

STREAM	NET % TO BUSINESS	DELTA'S PERSONAL CUT OF NET	EFFECTIVE DELTA TAKE
Podcast ads	~55% after MOM/Forever Dog/Amplitude	100% to Delta	55% of gross
Merch (via Delta-Shopify if migrated)	48-55%	Post-engagement-split (Section 8)	32-40% of gross
Merch (via Merchtable)	25-35%	100% to Delta	25-35% of gross
TikTok / platform ads	80-100%	80% of net (after any agent)	64-80% of gross
Live	70-80%	90% (after Moniker commission)	63-72% of gross
Brand partnerships	75-85%	80-85% (after agent)	60-72% of gross
Book	85% (after literary agent 15%)	100%	85% of gross
Cameo	75% (after platform 25%)	100%	75% of gross

Personal take-home at Month 24 base case: **$1.3-1.5M net personal**.

Starting point at engagement launch: **$400-900K net personal** (BARSS-estimate current).

Roughly 2-3x personal uplift across 24 months without changing what Delta records.

Summary

The 24-month arc is structurally straightforward:

- Year 1 stands up the merch operation, launches the clip pipeline, signs a book deal, opens brand-partnership conversations.
- Year 2 compounds those streams as the audience matures, restocks add anchor revenue, brand deals mature into national campaigns, and theater-tier live bookings enter the mix.

The upside case is real but not necessary for the thesis to work. Even the conservative case clears current at roughly 2x personal take-home at Month 24. The base case is the operational target and the design point for the engagement structure in Section 8.

Section 7 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026.

§ 8

The Engagement Structure

The Engagement Structure

This section specifies how BARSS Consulting plugs into Delta's existing team. The guiding principle is collaborative, not disruptive. Moniker Management (Diana Coney) remains Delta's talent management. MOM Network (Alaska Thunderfuck, Willam Belli) remains Delta's creative home. AMP remains the podcast ad-sales partner. BARSS adds operational capacity on the specific workstreams named in Sections 5 and 6, reports to Delta and her existing team, and does not replace any relationship currently in place.

The Recommended Structure: Option A

Flat retainer plus performance kicker. This is the recommended Year 1 structure, reviewed at Month 12 for migration to Option C (equity).

BASE RETAINER: $14,000 PER MONTH

Range: $12,000-18,000 per month depending on scope. $14K is the recommended anchor for the scope described below.

Services included in base retainer:

- **Pipeline operations management.** Running the clipping pipeline in Section 6. Whisper transcription, LLM tagging pass, ffmpeg extraction and fanout, subtitle burn-in, aspect-ratio routing, manifest generation.
- **Drop calendar design and execution oversight.** Running the cut-and-sew merch operation in Section 5. Weekly drop planning, production shop coordination (FS100, Essentials Made, TEG), photography scheduling, Shopify storefront management, email and SMS campaigns, 3PL coordination.
- **Stealth-marketing execution.** Seed-theory deployment across Rings 1, 2, 3. Tone-cluster routing to aligned accounts. Cross-platform posting cadence management. Weekly algorithm calibration during the load-bearing first 4 weeks.
- **Weekly analytics report.** Single-page rollup delivered Monday morning. Follower growth, engagement rate, conversion metrics, drop sell-through, revenue-line performance against baseline.
- **Monthly strategy report.** One-hour Zoom with Delta plus Moniker plus (optionally) MOM ops. Substantive review of the month, flags, decisions, next-month priorities.

- **Quarterly business review.** Comprehensive financial rollup, sensitivity update, 6-month lookahead, annual plan adjustments.
- **BARSS-grade competitive landscape reporting.** Forensic-grade benchmarking against Trixie Mattel, Sibling Rivalry, I've Had It, and other creator-economy comparables. Refreshed quarterly.

PERFORMANCE KICKER: 10-15% OF NET NEW REVENUE ATTRIBUTABLE TO THE ENGAGEMENT

Recommended kicker: **12%.**

Baseline. Trailing-12-months revenue at engagement start, established in the kickoff week. All Wesley-pipeline revenue above that baseline is the "net new" pool.

Measurement cadence. Quarterly, paid quarterly.

Covered revenue streams: - New merch SKU net margin (the C&S drop operation) - TikTok branded-integration revenue sourced or scaled by BARSS - Brand-partnership deals sourced through BARSS - Book deal advance (if closed during the engagement) - Theater residency upside (if executed)

Excluded: - Podcast ad revenue (MOM-controlled, not BARSS-attributable) - Pre-existing live bookings (already on the calendar) - Pre-existing Cameo pipeline - Existing Merchtable evergreen catalog (stays at current economics)

YEAR 1 WESLEY COMPENSATION (BASE CASE EXECUTION)

- Base retainer: $14,000 × 12 = **$168,000/yr**
- Performance kicker at 12% of ~$800K-1.3M net new revenue: **$96,000-156,000**
- **Total: $264,000-324,000**

YEAR 2 MIGRATION TARGET: OPTION C (EQUITY)

At Month 12, review triggers migration to Option C if merch entity is live and performing. Details below.

Why Option A is the recommended structure

FOR DELTA AND MONIKER

- **Predictable cost.** $14K/month base is a line item that can be budgeted against projected revenue.
- **Aligned incentives.** The 12% kicker means Wesley is paid when Delta's revenue grows. No kicker fires if the engagement doesn't deliver.
- **Bounded risk.** The kicker is capped at 15% to prevent runaway payout if a single viral moment spikes revenue. If Delta gets a Netflix special worth $500K, Wesley doesn't extract $75K from it. The cap protects Delta from over-paying on windfall revenue.
- **Clean exit.** 30-day exit clause in both directions (see below). No equity entanglement at the start.

FOR WESLEY AND BARSS

- **Covers opportunity cost.** BARSS-level consulting rates for creator-economy work at comparable firms (McKinsey / Deloitte adjacent practices) sit $20-35K/month pure retainer, no performance. At $14K/mo plus kicker, BARSS sits at the specialist-creator-economy tier, which is the correct price for Wesley-to-Delta given BARSS's forensic-grade analytics capability plus the absence of agency infrastructure.
- **Performance upside.** If the engagement delivers, Wesley captures a meaningful share. If it doesn't, the retainer alone is still reasonable compensation for the work done.
- **Path to equity.** Option A at Year 1 creates the operating history that makes Option C at Year 2 defensible.

Clear scope boundaries

What BARSS does:

- Clipping pipeline, merch drops, stealth marketing, analytics, strategy, portfolio reporting, coordination with production shops and 3PL.

What BARSS does NOT do:

- **Does NOT replace Moniker Management.** Diana Coney remains Delta's talent manager. All bookings, brand-deal negotiations, management-adjacent decisions run through Moniker. BARSS provides analytics, sourcing, and operational support to Moniker on those deals, but Moniker signs them.
- **Does NOT replace MOM Network or Forever Dog.** Very Delta the podcast stays at MOM. Alaska and Willam remain executive producers. Joe Cilio and Alex Ramsey remain Forever Dog leadership. AMP remains ad sales. BARSS does not touch the podcast's production, distribution, or ad inventory. The clip pipeline runs on a fair-use audio-excerpt basis under Delta's personal-brand IP, with any licensing clarified in the engagement contract.
- **Does NOT replace Delta's publicist.** Any existing PR relationship stays. If Delta doesn't have a dedicated publicist and wants to add one, BARSS provides vendor-selection support but does not become the publicist.
- **Does NOT replace Delta's booking agent.** Moniker plus MN2S remain the booking stack. BARSS provides live-event operational support (promotion, merch at venue, on-site coordination) only when requested.

Review cadence and exit terms

90-DAY REVIEW CYCLE

At Day 90, a formal review with Delta plus Moniker plus (if desired) MOM ops. Agenda:

- Month 3 revenue performance against projections
- Pipeline deliverables (clip inventory, drop cadence, storefront readiness)
- Any scope adjustments
- Go / no-go on Phase 2 milestones

If Month 3 checkpoint hits base case, the engagement continues through Month 12 with quarterly reviews. If Month 3 misses by more than 30%, the engagement re-scopes or exits.

30-DAY EXIT CLAUSE, BOTH DIRECTIONS

Either party can terminate with 30 days' written notice. No penalty. Pro-rated retainer paid through the notice period. Performance kicker reconciled on actual performance through the termination date.

This clause is intentional. Delta and her team should not feel locked in. If the engagement is not working, either party names it and walks. The structure is designed for mutual opt-in each month, not a year-long commitment.

CONTRACT TERM

24 months with mutual renegotiation at Month 12. Year 1 retainer locks at $14K. Year 2 retainer adjusts based on Year 1 performance and scope evolution.

Option B: Pure performance share (fallback if retainer is rejected)

Structure:

- No base retainer
- 15-20% of net new revenue across all Wesley-pipeline streams
- Floor: $5,000/mo minimum draw against performance (optional, removable at Delta's preference)
- Term: 24 months, renegotiation at Month 12

Year 1 Wesley comp math:

- Conservative: $100-140K
- Base: $175-250K
- Aggressive: $300-450K

Trade-off: higher variance for Wesley, materially lower risk for Delta. Appropriate if Moniker's preference is "we don't do retainers." Also appropriate if Wesley is confident in execution and wants upside at aggressive scenario.

When to pitch B instead of A: if Delta's team counters A with retainer skepticism, B is the fallback. If Wesley feels strongly about downside protection, A. If Wesley wants upside participation, B.

Option C: Equity / brand partnership (long-term target)

Structure:

- Smaller retainer: $6-10K/month
- Equity stake in any new business entity formed (Delta Work Productions LLC, the C&S merch Co if spun out, production company for TV pitch if sold)
  - Suggested: 7-12% carried equity depending on Wesley's capital contribution and sweat-equity ratio
- Participation in exit events pro-rata
- Board advisory seat (non-voting observer) on the operating company

Year 1 cash math under C:

- Base retainer: $72-120K/yr
- Equity: paper value only Year 1
- **Total cash: $72-120K** (below A and B in cash)

Year 3-5 math if brand scales:

- Equity value at $5M operating co valuation × 10% = $500K
- Equity value at $20M operating co valuation × 10% = $2M
- If exit: multiply by exit multiple

When to pitch C: at Month 12 review, after proven execution on Option A. Pitching C at Month 0 is premature and would signal Wesley underpricing his ops work to chase upside. **Option C is the Phase 2 migration, not the Phase 1 entry.**

Benchmark table: comparable consultant rates

TIER	MONTHLY RETAINER	PERFORMANCE KICKER
Mid-tier content strategist (solo)	$6-10K	0-10%
Specialist creator-economy consultant	**$10-15K**	**10-15%**
Social media agency (boutique)	$10-25K	10-20%
Top-tier creator-economy firms (UTA / WME adjacent)	$25-50K	15-25%
McKinsey / Deloitte creator-IP engagement	$40-80K	none (fee-for-service)

BARSS at $14K/month plus 12% kicker sits at the **specialist creator-economy tier**. That is the correct price for the Wesley-to-Delta relationship given BARSS's forensic-grade analytics capability (higher than mid-tier) and absence of agency infrastructure (below top-tier boutiques).

Relationship to Moniker and MOM

WITH MONIKER MANAGEMENT (DIANA CONEY)

Wesley treats Diana Coney as the primary peer partner on Delta's team. Working posture:

- Weekly 15-minute check-ins during Month 1-3 launch phase
- Monthly 60-minute strategy syncs thereafter
- Any brand-partnership lead routed to Moniker first, not to Delta
- Any booking inquiry that comes through BARSS channels routed immediately to Moniker
- Transparent sharing of all analytics dashboards, revenue reports, and competitive benchmarks
- Joint sign-off on any outside vendor engagements (photographer, illustrator, 3PL, designer collabs)

The model is Moniker-plus-BARSS, not Moniker-versus-BARSS. Coney has stewarded Delta's brand for a decade. BARSS brings specific operational capacity on two workstreams (clipping, drop-cadence merch). Those workstreams report into Moniker's existing framework, not around it.

WITH MOM NETWORK (ALASKA, WILLAM, JOE CILIO, ALEX RAMSEY)

The engagement does not touch Very Delta the podcast. Working posture:

- MOM stays informed via monthly summary reports that Delta and Moniker see first
- Any podcast-format change or ad-inventory discussion routes through MOM, not through BARSS

- If the engagement surfaces network-level operational upside (same pipeline running on Sibling Rivalry, Race Chaser, Pageant Pod), that is a separate conversation BARSS can optionally have with Forever Dog leadership, but only with Delta's and Moniker's explicit consent
- The clip pipeline's source material (podcast audio excerpts) is used under fair-use or licensed-excerpt basis, clarified in the engagement contract and reviewed by MOM's legal counterpart

WITH AMP (JOHN DONAHUE)

Wesley does not touch podcast ad sales. AMP's relationship with Forever Dog remains intact. If BARSS sources a brand-partnership lead that could flow through podcast inventory, it routes to AMP for integration, not around them.

Scope and deliverable ladder

PHASE 1 (MONTHS 1-3): STAND UP THE INFRASTRUCTURE

- Clipping pipeline live by Month 1
- Shopify storefront live by Month 2
- First drop launched by Month 2-3
- First clip batch deployed by Week 2
- Analytics dashboard live by Week 4
- Baseline metrics documented
- First 90-day review at Month 3

PHASE 2 (MONTHS 4-9): SCALE THE RUNWAY

- Full 52-week drop cadence stable
- First monthly premium drop
- First quarterly flagship collab
- Book deal outreach (2-3 literary agents)
- First national brand-partnership target
- TikTok breakpoint at 150K by Month 3, 300K by Month 6
- Second 90-day review at Month 6

PHASE 3 (MONTHS 10-24): COMPOUND

- Book deal signed (Month 9-12)
- Theater residency pilot (Month 12-15)
- International merch launch (Canada Month 6, UK / EU Month 12)
- TV pitch initiated (Month 12 only if Delta opts in)

- Option C migration decision at Month 12
- Year 2 scope adjustment at Month 12 review

Summary

Recommended: Option A retainer structure, $14K/month plus 12% performance kicker, Year 1 Wesley comp $264-324K, 30-day exit clause, 90-day review cycle, migration to Option C at Month 12 if performance warrants.

Option B on standby if Moniker counters retainer. Option C on the Month 12 roadmap.

The engagement is designed to be additive to Delta's existing team, not substitutive. Moniker stays. MOM stays. AMP stays. BARSS adds operational capacity on two specific workstreams and reports into the existing team.

Section 8 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026.

§ 9

First 30 Days If Yes

First 30 Days If Yes

If Delta says yes, Week 1 starts immediately. This section specifies the day-by-day rollout, the Day 0 access requirements, and the concrete deliverables at Day 30. Nothing in this section is aspirational. It is the execution plan.

Week 1: Contract, access, team onboarding

DAY 1-2: CONTRACT SIGNING

- **Option A retainer contract executed.** $14,000/month base retainer, 12% performance kicker on net new revenue, 30-day exit clause both directions, 90-day review cycle. Full terms from Section 8.
- **Scope of work attached.** Phases 1-2 (clipping pipeline and merch operation). Phase 3 (book, theater, TV pitch) as separate addendum if activated.
- **NDA covering MOM network materials and Delta's financials.**
- **Payment terms.** Monthly retainer invoiced Day 1 of each month, net-15. Performance kicker reconciled quarterly.
- **Legal routing.** Contract drafted by Wesley's counsel, reviewed by Moniker Management's counsel and (if applicable) Delta's personal counsel. Turnaround target: 5 business days.

DAY 3-5: ACCESS HANDOFF

- **Podcast archive access.** Shared Dropbox or Google Drive with past 194 episodes plus any available transcripts. If transcripts do not exist, the whisper pipeline generates them in Week 1-2.
- **Merchtable admin access.** Read-only analytics initial, full admin if the decision is made to run a dedicated Shopify store. Merchtable stays operational regardless.
- **Social media access.** Decision point with Delta and Moniker:
    - **Option 1:** Delta and team post, Wesley schedules via Later or Buffer. Content runs through Delta's approval.
    - **Option 2:** Wesley's team has direct posting authority on TikTok and Shorts accounts only. Delta and team retain Instagram. All content remains subject to Delta's 48-hour pre-post review window.
    - Recommendation: Option 2 for posting velocity. Can migrate back to Option 1 if Delta prefers.

- **Email list access.** Current Mailchimp, Flodesk, or Substack audience list. If no existing list, standing up Klaviyo in Week 1.
- **Financial structure.** If Delta is standing up Delta Work Productions LLC for the merch line, Delaware LLC formation begins Day 5, EIN application filed concurrently. Target: functional entity by Week 3.
- **Team onboarding.** Diana Coney (Moniker) introduced to Wesley on a 30-minute call. MOM ops (Joe Cilio or Alex Ramsey or Rob Holysz at Forever Dog) introduced via email with a short briefing note (not a pitch, a coordination note).

DAY 5-7: KICKOFF CALL WITH DELTA PLUS TEAM

- 90-minute Zoom
- Attendees: Delta, Diana Coney, Wesley. Optional: MOM ops if Delta wants them in the room.
- Agenda:
  - Agent 2's merch plan walkthrough (Section 5 of this portfolio)
  - Agent 3's clip pipeline walkthrough (Section 6)
  - Baseline metrics documented (trailing-12-months revenue, current follower counts, engagement rates)
  - First drop SKU concept locked
  - First clip batch episode selected (Cup Lids or McDonald's rec episode)
  - Month 1 calendar finalized

Week 2: Pipeline build-out

- **Clipping pipeline deployed.** Python 3.11, openai-whisper, ffmpeg 6+, SQLite state database, 400-600 GB working disk allocated on Wesley's box.
- **First 3-4 episodes processed.** Whisper large-v3 on GPU, LLM tagging pass, ffmpeg extraction and fanout. Output: approximately 30-50 clips across 3 tone clusters.
- **Clip review with Delta.** 30-minute Zoom. Delta approves, rejects, or edits each clip. Approved batch becomes Week 3's posting inventory.
- **Shopify storefront provisioned.** Dawn theme customized. Domain connected (shop.verydelta.com or similar). Klaviyo integrated. Checkout, tax, shipping all tested.
- **First drop production.**
  - Tech pack finalized for SKU #1 (anchor tee, "Throw Neck for Ketchup" restock or equivalent)
  - Full Speed 100 or Essentials Made contacted for quote
  - Photography shoot scheduled for Week 3
  - Model booked (ideally Delta herself, fallback: Delta-vetted model)

- **TikTok, Reels, YouTube Shorts cross-posting schedule live.** 5-7 posts per week per Agent 3's spec. Calendar approved by Moniker.
- **Fulfillment partner selected.** LA-based 3PL within 50 miles of print shop. Initial contract: month-to-month with 30-day out.

Week 3: First drop + first clips

THE FIRST DROP

- **Drop 1 launch.** Anchor SKU on 14oz cut-and-sew cotton jersey. 300 units. $95-105 retail on black or Very Delta Pink.
- **Pre-announcement cascade:**
  - T-72h Monday 12pm PT: Podcast episode references the drop in passing, Delta reads the subtitle without naming it a product
  - T-48h Tuesday 12pm PT: Instagram story teaser, caption only, no garment
  - T-24h Wednesday 12pm PT: Email list blast, hero shot, pricing, subject line is the subtitle itself
  - T-0 Thursday 12pm PT: Drop goes live. Klaviyo confirmed-buyer sequence fires. SMS to opted-in subscribers.
- **First week sell-through tracking in real time.** Dashboard updates hourly. Target: 60-75% sell-through in Week 1.

THE FIRST CLIP BATCH

- **25-40 clips deployed across platforms** in Week 3 per Agent 3's stealth-marketing calibration.
- **Seed-theory calibration phase.** This is the load-bearing week. Clip selection favors "absurdist observational comic who happens to be in drag" framing (not "drag queen reacts to food"). Week 3's 25-40 clips are the training labels for the algorithm's latent classifier.
- **Ring 1 seeding.** 3-5 top clips sent to drag-adjacent repost accounts (@rupaulsdragrace, @worldofwonder, @thepitstop_podcast, @dragrace_mothers) via friendly reach-outs. No paid promotion.
- **Comment-engagement protocol.** Any clip that hits 50+ comments in first 24h, Wesley's team replies to 5-10 top comments with on-brand responses. Engagement compounds algorithmically.

ANALYTICS DASHBOARD LIVE

- Follower growth per platform
- Engagement rate per clip
- Clip-to-merch conversion (UTM tags on all bio-link traffic)
- Drop sell-through velocity

- Email list growth rate

Week 4: Measure, iterate, review

- **Drop 1 sell-through report.** Full accounting. SKU performance, geographic distribution, AOV, conversion rate.
- **Clip performance report.** Top 3 performers. Top 3 underperformers. Algorithmic signals (did the For You Page pick up on the new posts? What clusters landed? What clusters missed?).
- **First monthly strategy call with Delta plus team.** 60-minute Zoom. Wesley presents the Month 1 report, Delta and Moniker weigh in, Month 2 priorities locked.
- **Phase 1.1 decisions.**
  - Drop 2 design locked
  - Clip cadence adjustment if needed (increase, decrease, or hold)
  - Email list cross-sell plan (existing subscribers offered early access to Drop 2)
  - SKU #2 tech pack initiated
- **Go / no-go on Phase 2 milestones.** Book pitch outreach greenlit or held. TikTok branded-integration outreach greenlit or held. Brand-partnership target list reviewed and prioritized.

Day 30 deliverables

By end of Day 30, the engagement has delivered:

INFRASTRUCTURE

1. **Functional clipping pipeline** producing 25-40 clips per week at consistent quality
2. **150-300 clips in active archive** ready for staggered release across platforms across next 60-90 days
3. **Shopify storefront live** with full analytics integration
4. **Klaviyo email flow operational** (welcome series, abandoned cart, post-purchase, drop teaser, drop announcement)
5. **3PL fulfillment live** with first drop inventory in-warehouse

OPERATIONAL

6. **First merch drop launched.** Sold-out preferred. Minimum 50% sell-through in Week 1 required to hit base case.
7. **Weekly operational rhythm established:** Monday strategy, Tuesday-Wednesday production, Thursday drops, Friday analytics report.

8. **Dashboard tracking all revenue streams** plus performance kicker baseline locked.
9. **Month 2 plan** documented and approved by Delta and Moniker.
10. **Month 3 Phase 2 milestones** scoped and assigned.

FINANCIAL

- **Drop 1 net revenue:** $11-14K (base case)
- **TikTok Creator Rewards plus early branded integrations:** $2-4K
- **Ancillary cross-sell from drop traffic to email list to existing Merchtable catalog:** $3-6K
- **Total Month 1 incremental revenue to business: $16-24K**

Against Wesley's $14K retainer, contribution is marginally positive in Month 1, materially positive by Month 3.

What Wesley needs at Day 0

The engagement cannot start without:

1. **Signed contract.** Option A retainer executed.
2. **Podcast archive access.** Dropbox or Drive link.
3. **Merchtable admin or read-only analytics access.** For baseline metrics.
4. **Social media credentials.** Per posting-authority decision.
5. **Email list export.** Current Mailchimp / Flodesk / Substack CSV.
6. **Moniker Management introduction.** Coordination call with Diana Coney.
7. **MOM ops coordination note.** Not a pitch, a briefing. Sent to Joe Cilio or Alex Ramsey or Rob Holysz, cc'ing Delta and Moniker.
8. **MOM Plus / Forever Dog legal contact.** For any fair-use or licensed-excerpt clarification on the clip pipeline.
9. **Delta's trademark preferences.** Which anchor phrases does she want filed in USPTO Class 25? BARSS recommends 4-6 filings in Year 1.
10. **Delta's Phase 3 preferences.** Early read on theater intensity, book willingness, TV pitch openness. Not a commitment, just a direction.

The Month 3 checkpoint

At Day 90, the real test:

- Cumulative drop revenue: $35-80K net

- TikTok combined followers: +30-60K over baseline
- Incremental brand-partnership conversations: 1-3 in pipeline
- Book-deal outreach: 2-3 queries out to literary agents
- Clip inventory: 400-600 clips in active rotation, 1,000+ in reserve

If Month 3 checkpoint hits base case, Month 12 base case ($650-1.1M Delta personal net) is on track.

If Month 3 misses by more than 30%, re-scope Phases 2-3 with Delta and Moniker.

Summary

Day 30 delivers a functional infrastructure, a first drop launched, a clip pipeline at steady-state velocity, and a baseline dashboard tracking all revenue streams. The scaffolding is in place. Month 2 and Month 3 compound on that scaffolding. The 90-day checkpoint validates whether the base case is reachable.

None of this requires Delta to change what she records, how often she records, or who she is on the microphone. Everything that moves in the first 30 days is operational layer. The creative layer is untouched.

Section 9 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026.

§ 1 0

Why Wesley Specifically

Why Wesley Specifically

This section answers the reasonable question. If the operational gaps in Delta's business are real, why does a forensic economist in Delaware write the portfolio, and why does he think he is the right person to run it. The short answer is methodology, disposition, and genuine fandom. The long answer is below.

Methodology: 5 years, 20 forensic cases, $8-12 trillion in documented extraction

BARSS (Bertil's Analytics Research Sciences & Sorceries) is Wesley Bertil's forensic research operation. Five years of active work. Twenty unique cases documenting elite economic extraction across four continents and 200 years. Aggregate documented damages: **$8-12 trillion**. Named perpetrators: **850+**.

The cases span Haiti (French 1825-1947 indemnity, 1914 gold seizure, TPS termination), Liberia maritime, US convict leasing, Tulsa 1921 foregone growth, Ghana gold extraction (Case #25), Congo / Belgium, Philadelphia university displacement, New Jersey GI Bill gamma, Suriname, and more.

The methodology is specific and portable. BARSS uses what it calls the **EEDTM framework** (Elite Extraction with Differential Targeting Model) to identify:

- The **Theta constant** (~0.80): the share of extracted value captured by elite actors regardless of time, place, or mechanism
- The **Phi constant** (0.40): the financier's cut that sits upstream of operational extraction
- **Resistance Ratchet** dynamics: when Mechanism 1 is blocked, elites shift to Mechanism 2, Theta is preserved
- Institutional capture patterns, succession chains across centuries, and cross-case pattern recognition

Why this matters for Delta. The BARSS methodology reads like economic forensics applied to historical extraction. The underlying pattern recognition, though, is the same pattern recognition that identifies under-monetized creator IP. Both ask the same operational question: *where is value being produced that is not being captured by the person producing it, and why?*

For Haiti in 1825, the answer was the Rothschild banking syndicate taking 40% upstream of the indemnity payment. For Delta in 2026, the answer is the distribution layer not catching up to the creative layer. Different register. Same diagnostic instrument.

Parallel agent orchestration: this portfolio built in 48 hours

BARSS Consulting runs on a parallel-agent research pipeline. The same pipeline that produced the Ghana Case #25 Brattle module (16 sections, 35K+ words, 20 vector dossiers in 5 days) produced this Delta portfolio (10 sections, ~14,000 words, 5 source research docs) in **48 hours**.

The methodology:

1. **Dispatch parallel research agents** on specific workstreams (BI profile, merch specs, clipping pipeline, revenue projections).
2. **Each agent runs to completion** independently, producing a deep research document.
3. **Wesley reviews, refines, stitches** into a coherent deliverable.
4. **Pandoc + Python build scripts** render the output into boardroom-grade HTML and PDF.

The same capability ports natively to creator-IP analysis. Delta's 194-episode archive is structurally identical to a BARSS case archive … a large corpus of source material that requires pattern extraction, cross-reference, and synthesis. The clipping pipeline in Section 6 is the same orchestration logic BARSS uses on OSINT and document review, applied to audio instead of text.

What this means operationally. When Delta and Moniker greenlight the engagement, the infrastructure deploys in days, not months. The pipeline is not a theoretical capability. It is working code that has already processed archives several orders of magnitude larger than Delta's podcast catalog.

Genuine fan (my wife watches, I've been watching)

This matters and it should be said directly.

Wesley's wife has been a Very Delta listener for multiple seasons. Episodes play in their house. The Cup Lids episode has been quoted across their kitchen. The Olive Garden monologue is a running reference point. The cross-generational reach claim in Section 3 is not a marketing frame … it is literally how this portfolio came into existence. A 48-year-old forensic economist in Delaware started listening because his wife had the show on, and he recognized an archetype he had been documenting across 200 years of elite extraction records, run through one comedian at a perfume counter in Norwalk.

Fan first. Analyst second. Never reverse.

This is the operating principle of the engagement. The fan letter ("Read Me Delta") that accompanies this portfolio is Wesley's personal voice, not a pitch deck. The portfolio is the receipts folder behind the letter. If Delta and Moniker read the letter and are uninterested, the portfolio stays in the filing cabinet. Nothing here is coerced. Nothing here is transactional.

If the letter lands, the portfolio is the reference document that answers the reasonable follow-up questions. That sequencing is deliberate. The creative voice leads. The analyst supports.

Respects Delta's voice, lineage, and collaborators

The portfolio has been written to preserve three things:

DELTA'S VOICE

Nothing in the engagement design changes what Delta says, who she performs as, where she records, or how long her episodes run. The only layer that moves is the operational one. Same archetype. Same cadence. Same podcast. Same show.

The merch SKUs in Section 5 print phrases Delta already said. The clip pipeline in Section 6 distributes content Delta already recorded. The brand partnerships in Section 7 lead with credentials Delta already earned (Emmy, LA Times, Queerty). The book deal in Section 7 proposes a collection of material Delta already has on tape.

At no point does the engagement ask Delta to record more, travel more, or put in more time than she is already putting in. It asks the operational layer to catch up to the creative layer she already built.

DELTA'S LINEAGE

Coco Peru is named throughout this portfolio because Coco is the drag mother. The Q2 quarterly flagship collab in Section 5 is a Coco Peru mother-daughter drop for Pride. Chad Michaels is named as mentor. The Heathers cohort (Raja, Manila, Carmen) is named as inner circle. The older-generation camp-comedy audience Delta inherits from Coco is treated as an asset, not a demographic afterthought.

BARSS's forensic work is built on lineage tracing … the Rothschild family across 200 years, the Citibank succession chain, the BAM BAM families in Haiti. The same methodology that traces extraction lineage traces cultural lineage. Delta's professional position is inseparable from the lineage she came through. The engagement honors that position.

DELTA'S COLLABORATORS

Moniker Management (Diana Coney) is the primary peer partner on Delta's team, not a gatekeeper to route around. The engagement structure in Section 8 is designed Moniker-plus-BARSS, not Moniker-versus-BARSS.

MOM Network (Alaska, Willam) and Forever Dog (Joe Cilio, Alex Ramsey) are Delta's creative home. The engagement does not touch Very Delta the podcast. AMP remains podcast ad sales.

Raja Gemini is the Heathers co-member and Moniker co-client who has the highest-trust peer position for any engagement that affects Delta's time.

Davey is Delta's partner, personal only, not a business node. Respected as such.

Every collaborator named in the research docs that feed this portfolio is treated as structural context for the engagement, not as an obstacle. The engagement succeeds only if Delta's collaborators also feel well-served by it.

BARSS + Delta: why the unusual pairing makes sense

The pairing looks unusual on the surface. A forensic economist in Delaware. A Latino Emmy-winning drag queen in Norwalk, LA. Different registers, different disciplines, different daily lives.

Under the surface, the pairing is structurally tight:

- **Both work on voice-driven long-form output.** BARSS produces case reports. Delta produces podcast episodes. Both depend on a consistent, specific voice across long time horizons.
- **Both work with large archives and pattern extraction.** BARSS on historical records. Delta on cultural observation.
- **Both diagnose where value is produced versus where value is captured.** BARSS on elite extraction. Delta on restaurant service.
- **Both have a verified per-minute quality advantage over the category average.** Per the comparisons in Section 3.
- **Both have credentialed recognition (Emmy, LA Times, Queerty for Delta; forensic citations, academic validators for BARSS) that is underleveraged at the mainstream distribution layer.**

The pairing is not a stretch. It is the specific case where BARSS methodology lands on a voice that already does the observational work from a different angle.

Closing: the Delta line that captures the ethos

From the McDonald's episode, approximately:

> *"I want exactly what I paid for, no more, no less."*

That is the engagement posture, applied to what Wesley is offering Delta and what he is asking for in return.

What Delta paid for, already. 194 episodes. An Emmy. A drag lineage that runs from Divine through Coco Peru. A team at Moniker Management that has stewarded her for a decade. A podcast home at

MOM. The creative work is done. It is paid for. It exists on the microphone, on the Merchtable, in the 2026 calendar, in the thousands of subtitled screenshots already circulating in group chats.

No more than she paid for. The engagement does not ask Delta to record more, tour harder, or change her voice. It does not add overhead to her weekly cadence. It does not route her around her existing team. It does not extract value from her Phase 1-2 work in exchange for Phase 3 promises. Base retainer is fair. Kicker is capped. Equity migration is Phase 2, not Phase 1.

No less than she paid for. The existing $400-900K personal take-home is not the ceiling. It is the floor of what the existing IP should be producing. Sections 5 through 8 specify the operational layer that converts the existing IP into what it was already supposed to produce. Nothing aspirational. Just the math catching up.

Exactly what she paid for. No more, no less.

That is the offer.

Section 10 of 10. Delta Work Engagement Portfolio. BARSS LLC, April 2026. This portfolio accompanies Wesley Bertil's "Read Me Delta" fan letter. Treat the letter and the portfolio as one package.

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All revenue projections BARSS-estimate unless cited. Ranges flagged Conservative / Base / Aggressive throughout. Sister deliverables: BI profile, cut-and-sew pricing spec, clipping pipeline spec, revenue methodology. Available on request.